



FoLang Programming Language

FoLang is a general-purpose programming language designed to be **expressive, consistent, and extensible**, merging functional fluency with object-centric abstractions.

Design Overview

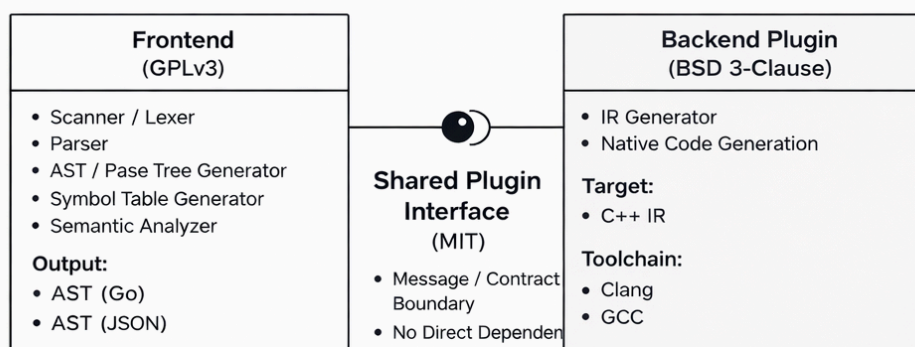


Figure: Frontend and Backend are independent components connected exclusively through a shared plugin interface, which acts as a strict integration and licensing boundary.

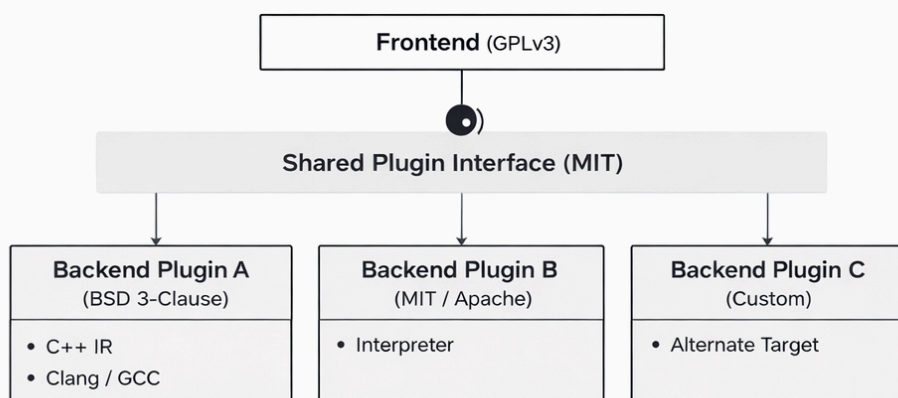


Figure: The Backend itself is a plugin. Multiple backend implementations can coexist or be swapped without modifying the Frontend.

FoLang follows a deliberately different approach from conventional programming language designs. The system is structured to ensure **clear separation of concerns, license isolation, and extensibility through well-defined integration boundaries**.

1. Frontend

The Frontend is responsible for source-level analysis and semantic processing of FoLang programs.

Components

- Scanner / Lexer
- Parser
- AST / Parse Tree Generator
- Symbol Table Generator
- Semantic Analyzer

Implementation

- Implemented in **Go**
- Generates AST representations in **Go structures** or **plain JSON**

License

- **GNU General Public License v3 (GPLv3)**

Why the Frontend Is Not Pluggable

FoLang's syntax is **fixed and closed**. All language extensibility — operators, generics, macros, annotations, type extensions, custom matchers — is expressed through the built-in `@co.dap` and `@co.ddap` annotation system within the fixed syntax. There is no mechanism to introduce new syntax from outside the language.

Because no external component can alter what the frontend parses or how it builds the AST, a frontend plugin architecture would add complexity with no benefit. The frontend is therefore a **single, fixed, non-pluggable component**.

Extensibility need	How FoLang handles it
New syntax	Not allowed — syntax is fixed
New operators	<code>@co.dap.operator</code> — declared in-language
Generics	<code>@co.dap.generic</code> — annotation-driven
Macros	<code>@co.dap.macro</code> — AST manipulation in-language
Annotations / decorators	<code>@co.dap.annotation</code> etc. — in-language
Type extensions	<code>@co.dap.extension</code> — in-language
Custom matchers	<code>@co.dap.matcher</code> — in-language

2. Backend

The Backend is responsible for transforming validated frontend output into executable artifacts.

The Backend itself is implemented and integrated as a **plugin**, using the same shared plugin interfaces available to third parties. The out-of-the-box (OOTB) backend is provided as a **default plugin implementation**.

Components

- Intermediate Representation (IR) Generator
- Native Binary Executable Generation

Implementation

- Backend orchestration and plugin integration implemented in **Go**

- Code generation target is **C++**
- Uses **Clang** or **GCC** to generate native binaries from generated C++ IR

License

- **BSD 3-Clause License**
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Why the Backend Is a Plugin

As illustrated in the architecture diagrams, the Backend is intentionally treated as a **pluggable component** rather than a privileged or tightly coupled part of the system.

This design ensures that the Frontend depends only on **stable interfaces**, not on any specific backend implementation. As a result, backend implementations can be added, replaced, or evolved independently without requiring changes to the Frontend.

Treating the Backend as a plugin also establishes a clear **integration and licensing boundary**, enabling multiple backend implementations — each with different execution models, targets, or licenses — to coexist behind the same shared interface.

3. Shared Interfaces

The Shared layer defines stable **contracts and interfaces** that any backend plugin must conform to. It is not itself a plugin — it is the integration boundary between the Frontend and any Backend implementation.

Purpose

- Defines the HIR schema that the Frontend produces and any Backend must consume
- Defines the IPC protocol and wire format contract
- Enables third parties to build custom backend implementations against a stable interface
- Acts as the strict boundary that allows Frontend and Backend to evolve independently

What Third Parties Can Do

Using the shared interfaces, third parties can provide custom Backend implementations in any language — as long as they conform to the HIR schema and IPC protocol declared here.

License

- **MIT License**
-

4. Plugin Configuration

FoLang uses a **minimal and explicit configuration file** to define how the Frontend and Backend are connected at runtime.

Each FoLang binary distribution includes:

- **Exactly one Frontend** — fixed, not configurable
- **Exactly one Backend** — selected via configuration

There is **no runtime plugin selection or discovery**. Different backend implementations are achieved by distributing different FoLang binaries or swapping the backend plugin.

Backend Kinds

There are two kinds of backend:

Kind 1 — Plugin backend implemented in the same language as the frontend (Go). Integrates directly via shared interfaces which are already versioned for backward compatibility. The frontend does not emit protobuf — it communicates through the shared

interfaces directly. Config needs only plugin path and version.

Kind 2 — Independent backend implemented in any language. The frontend emits HIR over an IPC boundary in the declared wire format. Config declares the full protocol, schema, and wire format.

Configuration File Structure

Kind 1 — Plugin backend

```
{
  "plugin":  "libs/folang-plugin",
  "version": "v1"
}
```

Kind 2 — Independent backend

```
{
  "protocol":  "folang-plugin/1.0",
  "hir_schema": "folang-hir/1",
  "wire":      "protobuf"
}
```

Licensing Summary

Layer	Pluggable?	Responsibility	Implementation	License
Frontend	✗ Fixed	Parsing and semantic analysis	Go	GPLv3
Backend	✓ Plugin	IR processing and native code generation	Go (orchestration) + C++ (target)	BSD 3-Clause
Shared	✓ Interfaces	Backend integration contracts and HIR schema	Go	MIT

6. Capability Security Model

FoLang's compiler ships with all language features compiled in but **systems and FFI features are disabled by default**. The compiler has no hardcoded keys — capability configuration happens entirely at install time. This moves authorization from source code (developer-controlled) to the compiler installation (organization-controlled).

Feature Tiers

Tier	Features	Default State
application	All standard language features, <code>co.net</code> , <code>co.core</code> , <code>co.encoding</code> , <code>co.crypto</code> , etc.	✓ Always enabled
system	Raw pointers, pointer arithmetic, <code>co.sys.unsafe</code> , MMIO, heap allocators	🔒 Disabled — requires install-time configuration
ffi	<code>@co.dap.native</code> , <code>co.sys.ffi</code> , extern types, <code>co.lang.void</code> pointers, C ABI	🔒 Disabled — requires install-time configuration

Quick Start

Hello World

```
// hello.fol – entry file, no annotation needed
co.out.println("Hello FoLang!")
```

Or with an alias for shorter form:

```
@co.ddap.alias(co.out, as="out")

out.println("Hello FoLang!")
```

Variables

```
// typed
name co.lang.string = "Rao";
age  co.lang.int    = 30;

// inferred from value – := errors if already declared
name := "Rao";
age  := 30;

// define and assign if not defined, otherwise reassign
name ?= "Kumar";
```

FoLang Philosophy — Uniform Object Model

Core Principle

Everything in **FoLang** is an object. That is the reason for the name **FO — Functional Objects**.

FoLang gives the programmer one uniform object model across all types instead of forcing them to switch between separate type families for:

- ordinary values
- immutable values
- shared/concurrent values
- copy-on-write values
- literal values

The programmer writes against a single conceptual model and opts into the required object behaviour only when needed.

Uniform Object Principle

In FoLang, **everything is an object**.

This includes:

- scalar objects
- collection objects
- user-defined objects
- ADT objects

- function objects

Functions are objects in the same sense as all other values.

This is true for both **named functions** and **anonymous functions**.

FoLang does not introduce a separate semantic model for functions, scalars, UDTs, or ADTs.

They all follow the same core object principles:

- assignment copies references
- `==` compares values
- mutation is applied through the object
- behaviour policies such as immutability, shared, copy-on-write, and literal conversion apply uniformly where meaningful

So in FoLang, the programmer does not need one mental model for data objects and another for function values.

The language treats them under one consistent object model.

1. Default Object Model

Every value in FoLang is an object and is **mutable by default**.

This includes:

```
co.lang.int, co.lang.float, co.lang.string → built-in scalar types
user-defined types (structs, classes, ADTs) → user-defined objects
co.core.list, co.core.map, co.core.array → built-in collections
```

Example:

```
positive_int co.lang.int = 10;
```

`positive_int` denotes an object.

Its current value is `10`.

By default, it is mutable.

2. Assignment, Aliasing, and Mutation

FoLang distinguishes three related ideas:

- **assignment**
- **aliasing**
- **mutation**

2.1 Assignment copies references

When one object variable is assigned to another, FoLang copies the **reference**, not the internal contents.

```
b := a
```

After this, `a` and `b` refer to the same object.

2.2 Mutation changes object contents

If two names refer to the same object, mutating through one name is visible through the other.

```

Employee co.lang.class = {
    Name co.lang.string
}

a Employee = { Name = "Kamesh" };
b := a;
c Employee = { Name = "Kamesh" };

a == b;    // true
a == c;    // true
b == c;    // true

b.Name = "Ramesh";    // changes a.Name too
c.Name = "Ramesh";    // does not change a.Name

```

Why:

- **a** and **b** are the **same object**
- **c** is a **different object** with the same earlier value

2.3 == means value equality

In FoLang, == compares **values**, not object identity.

That rule is uniform across all object kinds, including built-in types and user-defined types.

So:

```
a == b
```

means:

- compare contents deeply
- return **true** when the values match
- even if **a** and **b** are not the same object

2.4 Mutation accessors

The accessor used for mutation depends on the object type:

```

scalar (int, float, bool, string, char, byte)  → .value
struct field                                   → .fieldname
class member                                  → .membername
map entry                                       → .key
array / list element                           → .index

```

Examples:

```

count.value = 30
emp.name = "Rao"
marks.math = 95
nums.0 = 42 or nums[0] = 42 //both forms supported

```

2.5 Function-call behaviour

Function parameters introduce a **new local binding**.

So:

- rebinding a parameter does **not** affect the caller
- mutating the object through the parameter **does** affect the caller if both still refer to the same object

```
checkPositive(a co.lang.int)->(co.lang.bool) = {  
  a = 20;           // local rebinding only – caller unchanged  
  a.value = 30;     // object mutation – caller sees 30  
}
```

If `positive_int` is passed to `checkPositive(a)`:

```
a = 20           → local rebinding only  
a.value = 30     → mutates the passed object
```

3. Literal Objects

All literals in FoLang create **Literal Objects**.

```
"Kumar"  → Literal Object – string  
42       → Literal Object – int  
true     → Literal Object – bool
```

A Literal Object is an **anonymous object created from a literal expression**.

Literal Objects participate in value equality just like every other object in FoLang:

```
10 == 10  // true
```

In FoLang, `==` compares **values**, not object identity.

So two literal expressions with the same value compare equal, but that does not mean they are the same object.

Binding a Literal Object

When a literal is assigned to a named object, the name refers to the object created from that literal expression.

```
a co.lang.int = 10;
```

Here, `a` refers to the anonymous integer object created from literal `10`.

So:

```
a.value = 30;
```

mutates that same object, and `a` now has value `30`.

The important points are:

- literal expressions create anonymous objects
- literal-created objects are still ordinary objects unless another policy is applied
- `==` compares values, not identity
- once bound to a name, a literal-created object behaves like any other normal mutable object
- immutability applies only when explicitly requested, for example through `makeImmutable(...)`

Why Literal Objects Cannot Be Mutated Directly

Mutation can occur in two ways:

1. Through rebinding

Rebinding assigns a new object to an existing lvalue. `a co.lang.int = 10; a = 20;`

This is valid because `a` is an lvalue and can be rebound to another integer object. A literal object such as `10` is an rvalue, not an lvalue, so it cannot be rebound directly. `10 = 20; // ❌ invalid`

Rebinding is therefore permitted only through an assignable lvalue.

2. Through a property or method

An object may also be mutated through one of its mutable properties or methods. `a co.lang.int = 10; a.value = 20;`

This is valid because `a` provides a handle to the integer object, and its `value` property can be mutated. A bare literal object cannot be mutated directly because it does not provide properties/methods that can be accessed.

`10.value = 20; // ❌ invalid`

Once a literal object is bound to a variable, it behaves like an ordinary mutable object unless an immutability policy is applied.

```
a co.lang.int = 10;
a.value = 30;
```

is valid after binding, a bare literal such as `10` cannot be mutated directly because there is no name or handle through which to perform mutation.

Not the Same as `toSnapshot(...)`

A literal object created by a literal expression is **not** the same thing as the internal snapshot representation produced by `co.utils.toSnapshot(...)`.

- literal expression → anonymous object
- `toSnapshot(x)` → internal snapshot representation used to reconstruct a fresh local object later

These are related concepts, but they are not the same mechanism.

Summary

- literal objects are real objects
- literal expressions create anonymous objects
- identical literals compare equal by value
- identical literals are not automatically the same object
- literal-created objects are mutable by default once bound to a handle
- only `makeImmutable(...)` makes an object immutable

4. Object Behaviour Policies

Any object can be given a behaviour policy using `co.utils.*`.

All four policy calls are **in-place transformations**:

- the object itself changes behaviour kind
- there is no wrapper object
- there is no alternate binding to capture
- the original name now refers to the transformed object

All policies are **deep by default**.

They flow through nested structs, members, collection elements, and all reachable objects in the graph unless the specification later states otherwise.

4.1 Immutable

```
co.utils.makeImmutable(positive_int)
```

After this call the object itself is immutable.

This is an in-place transformation, not a wrapper.

Any attempt to mutate the object or any reachable object beneath it is a **compiler error** where detectable statically, and a **runtime error** otherwise.

```
positvie_int co.lang.int = 10;
positive_int.value = 30    // ✗ compiler error
positive_int = 30         // ✗ compiler error
```

For nested objects:

```
Employee co.lang.struct = { address Address; }
Address co.lang.Address = {city co.lang.string; state co.lang.string; lane co.lang.string; pin
co.lang.string;}

emp Employee = Employee{
    address:Address{
        city: "Pune";
    }
}
co.utils.makeImmutable(emp);

emp = Employee{
    address:Address{
        city: "ABC";
    }
} // ✗ compiler error

emp.address = newAddress           // ✗ compiler error
emp.address.city.value = "Mumbai" // ✗ compiler error
```

Immutability is deep and total.

4.2 Value Immutable

```
positive_int co.lang.int = 20;

co.utils.makeValueImmutable(positive_int);

positive_int.value = 30; // ❌ current object is immutable
positive_int = 30;      // ✅ binding may reference a new object

co.utils.makeValueImmutable(emp);

emp.address.city = "ABC";      // ❌
emp.address.city.value = "ABC"; // ❌

emp = Employee{
  address: Address{
    city: "ABC";
  }
}; // ✅
```

Difference between Immutable and Immutable Value

```
makeValueImmutable(x)
└─ current object graph cannot change

makeImmutable(x)
└─ current object graph cannot change
└─ binding cannot be reassigned
```

Table

Operation	Binding	Current value/object graph
<code>makeValueImmutable(x)</code>	Mutable	Immutable
<code>makeImmutable(x)</code>	Immutable	Immutable

4.3 Shared

```
co.utils.makeShared(positive_int)
```

A Shared Object is safe for concurrent and multi-threaded use.

The programmer continues to use the same object model — same accessors, same syntax — while FoLang guarantees the required safety properties internally.

Shared behaviour is deep:

- all reachable objects within the shared object are also shared

Note on Analogies

Comparisons to things like Java's `AtomicInteger` or `ConcurrentHashMap` are **analogies only**.

They may help explain the concept, but they are **not part of the formal language contract**.

FoLang specifies the behavioural guarantee, not the exact runtime implementation.

A good explanatory statement is:

A shared `co.lang.int` may be thought of similarly to an atomic integer, and a shared map may be thought of similarly to a concurrent map. These comparisons are explanatory only. FoLang does not require any particular internal runtime representation.

4.4 CopyOnWrite

```
co.utils.copyOnWrite(positive_int)
```

A `CopyOnWrite` Object passes by reference like a normal object.

The copy is deferred.

It is created only when mutation is attempted in a context that must not affect the original source object.

```
process(a co.lang.int)->() = {
    a.value = 99;    // deep copy is made here – caller's object unchanged
}

co.utils.copyOnWrite(positive_int)
process(positive_int)

// positive_int still holds its old value
```

Copy-on-write is deep.

When a copy is made, the entire reachable object graph is copied.

Cyclic references must be handled by the runtime/compiler's structural clone logic with proper identity tracking.

4.5 toSnapshot

```
co.utils.toSnapshot(positive_int)
```

`toSnapshot` converts an object into a **snapshot representation** — a value descriptor, not a live object. The snapshot representation itself cannot be mutated.

When passed to a function, the compiler/runtime uses the snapshot representation to construct a fresh independent local variable bound to the parameter name. That local is a normal mutable object with no shared identity with the original. All of this happens automatically — the developer writes only `co.utils.toSnapshot(positive_int)`.

```
process(a co.lang.int)->() = {
    a.value = 99;    // mutates the fresh local – positive_int completely unaffected
}

process(co.utils.toSnapshot(positive_int))
```

```
// positive_int unchanged
```

The flow:

```
positive_int
  ↓ co.utils.toSnapshot(positive_int)
  snapshot representation      ← value descriptor – immutable by nature, not by policy
  ↓ passed to function
  compiler constructs fresh local 'a' from the snapshot representation
  'a' is a new independent normal object – mutations never reach positive_int
```

`toSnapshot` is deep — the snapshot representation covers the entire reachable object graph.

5. Policy Summary

Object Kind	Mutation allowed	Caller sees mutation	Thread safe	Copy on write	Deep
Literal expression object	✗ directly in source — no handle	—	value-like use	—	✓
Normal (default)	✓ via accessor	✓	✗	✗	—
Immutable	✗	—	✓	—	✓
Shared	✓ via accessor	✓	✓	✗	✓
CopyOnWrite	✓ on own copy	✗	✓	✓	✓
toSnapshot result	✓ on reconstructed local object	✗	independent snapshot	—	✓

6. No Type Fragmentation

FoLang deliberately avoids special types for mutability or concurrency concerns.

There is no need for separate public type families such as:

```
ImmutableInt
SharedMap
CopyOnWriteList
AtomicInt
ConcurrentMap
```

Instead, FoLang keeps the type model uniform and applies behaviour policies through `co.utils.*`.

In many ecosystems, a programmer must constantly choose between:

```
normal integer      vs atomic integer
normal map          vs concurrent map
mutable value       vs immutable wrapper
raw structure       vs copy-on-write structure
```

FoLang instead aims to provide:

- one object model
- one programming style
- one mental model

while still allowing the programmer to opt into immutability, sharing, copy-on-write, or literal conversion when needed.

7. What Still Needs Precision

The philosophy is sound, but the formal specification still needs to define these precisely:

aliasing behaviour	→ when two names refer to the same object
rebinding vs mutation interaction	→ edge-case coverage
deep policy propagation rules	→ exactly which objects are reachable
cyclic reference handling in COW	→ identity-tracking specification
visibility of mutation across calls	→ formal function-call model
identity vs value equality	→ what operators or built-ins expose identity
policy stacking	→ can an object be both shared and COW? can an object be both shared and immutable?

8. Formal Philosophy Statement

In FoLang, everything is an object and objects are mutable by default.

Assignment copies references, while `==` compares values deeply.

Developers may opt into immutability, shared behaviour, copy-on-write behaviour, or literal conversion depending on their needs.

All behaviour policies are deep — they apply to the entire reachable object graph unless stated otherwise by the formal specification.

This model is uniform across all types, so programmers do not need separate mental models or separate type families for ordinary, immutable, concurrent, or snapshot-oriented use.

Familiar analogies such as atomic integers or concurrent maps may help explain the design, but they are not part of the formal implementation contract.

FoLang Packages, Imports, and Libraries

Packages

Package Identity

A subfolder containing `.fol` files **is** a package.

- Dot paths start from subfolders.
- The project root is **not** a package.
- The root folder name never appears in any package dot path.

Examples:

```
/appl/hr/           -> package "hr"
/appl/hr/employee/ -> package "hr.employee"
/appl/auth/         -> package "auth"
```

The project root itself is **not** a package.

It may contain:

- the application entry file
- the packaged library surface file when the project itself is a library
- subfolders that define packages or same-owner source libraries

Package Source Files

A `.fol` file located inside a package folder contains **exactly one primary top-level declaration**. This gives every package source file a clear structural identity and prevents unrelated declarations or loose functions from being mixed at file scope.

The primary declaration may be a:

- class
- struct
- cstruct
- enum
- union / ADT
- interface
- signature
- module
- type classes/instance
- type constructors
- patterns or objects
- macro
- template
- generics
- annotations
- decorators
- type, type alias, newtype, or opaque type
- unit

File-level import directives, aliases, and annotations may appear before the primary declaration. They do not count as additional primary declarations.

Forbidden directly at package-file scope:

- free-flowing functions
- variables or mutable state
- executable statements
- explicit package declarations
- project metadata
- library metadata
- multiple unrelated primary declarations

The application entry file and library surface files are special source forms and follow their own rules. The single-primary-declaration rule in this section applies to ordinary files inside package folders.

Primary Declaration Names and Filename Inference

The name of a primary declaration may be written explicitly or inferred from the source filename.

When `_` appears in the primary declaration-name position, the compiler derives the declaration name from the filename:

```
// Employee.fol
_ co.lang.struct = {
  id   co.lang.int;
  name co.lang.string;
}
```

This declares `Employee co.lang.struct`.

In this position, `_` does not declare an anonymous or discarded declaration. It means **use the filename-derived declaration name**.

An explicit declaration name is authoritative and overrides filename inference. The explicit name is not required to match the filename:

```
// employee_model.fol
Employee co.lang.struct = {
    id    co.lang.int;
    name  co.lang.string;
}
```

This still declares `Employee`; `employee_model.fol` is only the source filename.

Name-selection precedence is therefore:

```
explicit declaration name  -> use the explicit name
_                          -> derive the name from the filename
```

Filename derivation rules:

- for `Name.fol`, the inferred declaration name is `Name`
- for a kind-qualified filename such as `Name.unit.fol`, the compiler removes both `.fol` and the trailing kind suffix when that suffix matches the declaration kind
- the inferred result must be a valid FoLang identifier
- a kind-qualified filename whose suffix conflicts with the declaration kind is a compiler error
- filename inference supplies only the declaration name; generic parameters and all other declaration details remain explicit

Examples:

```
// Status.enum.fol
_ co.lang.enum = {
    active;
    inactive;
}
// inferred name: Status
```

```
// Box.struct.fol
_(T) co.lang.struct = {
    value T;
}
// inferred name: Box; T remains explicit
```

```
// Employee.struct.fol
_ co.lang.class = {
    ...
}
// compiler error: filename kind `struct` conflicts with declaration kind `class`
```

Filename inference may be used by named primary declarations such as classes, structs, cstructs, enums, unions, interfaces, signatures, modules, instances, objects, units, and named type declarations.

Example containing a data declaration:

```
// hr/employee/Employee.fol
_ co.lang.struct = {
  id    co.lang.int;
  name  co.lang.string;
}
```

When a file needs only ordinary free functions, those functions must be enclosed in a `co.lang.unit`:

```
// hr/employee/EmpService.fol
_ co.lang.unit = {

  getEmployee(id co.lang.int)->(Employee) = {
    this.return Employee{ id: 1, name: "Rao" };
  }
}
```

Multi-File Packages

Multiple `.fol` files in the same subfolder automatically belong to the same package:

```
hr/employee/
├─ Employee.fol      → hr.employee
├─ EmpService.fol    → hr.employee
└─ EmpValidator.fol  → hr.employee
```

Application Project Layout

```
/apl/
├─ app.fol           ← entry file – not a package
├─ hr/               package "hr"
│   └─ employee/     package "hr.employee"
│       ├── Employee.fol
│       └─ EmpService.fol
│   └─ payroll/      package "hr.payroll"
│       ├── Payroll.fol
│       └─ PayrollCalc.fol
├─ auth/             package "auth"
│   └─ Auth.fol
├─ bindings/         package "bindings"
│   └─ CLib.fol
```

Application Entry File

The application entry file is a **special executable source form** located at the application root. It is not a package, does not create an importable namespace, and is not subject to the ordinary package-file rule requiring exactly one primary declaration.

The compiler creates a dedicated **entry-file context** for it:

```

ApplicationEntryContext
├─ file directives, imports, and aliases
├─ entry-local non-structural type declarations
├─ non-capturing function-pattern groups
├─ capturing `let` function-pattern groups
└─ executable statements and expressions

```

Everything declared directly in this context is private to the entry file. Entry-local symbols cannot be imported, exported, or referenced by package or library source files.

Allowed Entry-File Constructs

The application entry file may contain:

- built-in directives that are valid for an entry file
- package and library imports
- import aliases declared with `as=`
- file-local aliases for `co.*` paths declared with `@co.ddap.alias`
- type aliases declared with `co.lang.type`
- new types declared with `co.lang.newtype`
- opaque types declared with `co.lang.opaquetype`
- dependent-type aliases and dependent-type usages that do not declare a type-constructor function
- subtype declarations
- supertype declarations
- non-capturing entry-local function-pattern groups
- capturing entry-local `let` function-pattern groups
- variable declarations, initialization, assignment, and mutation
- calls to built-in methods and functions
- calls to imported package and library APIs
- ordinary expressions
- comprehensions
- ternary expressions
- conditions and loops
- containment operations such as `contains`
- iterators such as `each`
- pattern matching and destructuring

Built-in and Imported Names

All `co.*` paths are always available and are never imported.

A developer may use the complete built-in path:

```

co.out.println("Hello");
co.core.list.of(1, 2, 3);

```

A developer may optionally create a file-local alias:

```

@co.ddap.alias(co.out, as="out")
@co.ddap.alias(co.core.list, as="list")

out.println("Hello");
values := list.of(1, 2, 3);

```

Creating an alias does not hide the complete `co.*` name; both forms remain valid in that file.

User packages and libraries are not automatically available. They must be imported. When `as=` is present, the imported API is accessed through that alias. When `as=` is omitted, the complete imported package or library path must be used.

```
@co.ddap.import(package="hr.employee", as="emp")
first := emp.EmployeeService.find(1001);

@co.ddap.import(package="finance.payroll")
second := finance.payroll.calculate(request);
```

Entry-Local Type Declarations

The entry file permits only the following named type-declaration families:

```
co.lang.type
co.lang.newtype
co.lang.opaquetype
co.lang.dependentType usage or alias
co.lang.subtype
co.lang.supertype
```

Example:

```
EmployeeId co.lang.newtype = co.lang.int;
InternalId co.lang.opaquetype = co.lang.int;
NumericId co.lang.type = co.lang.int;
PositiveId co.lang.subtype = co.lang.int;
Identifier co.lang.supertype = EmployeeId;
```

An entry-local `co.lang.type` declaration may name an already formed type expression, including a dependent type expression. It may not introduce a struct, class, enum, cstruct, union/ADT constructor family, generic type declaration, or user-defined type-constructor function.

A dependent type constructor imported from a package may be used:

```
values vector.Vector(10) = [...];
```

A type-constructor function may not be declared in the entry file:

```
Vector(n co.lang.int)->(co.lang.dependentType) =
  co.lang.int->([n]);
// compiler error: ordinary and type-constructor function declarations are forbidden
```

Entry-local types:

- are visible only in the entry file
- are not package members
- cannot be imported or exported
- cannot appear in a package or library public signature
- cannot be referenced by package or library implementations

- may be used by entry-file variables, bindings, expressions, comprehensions, matching, and function patterns

Entry-Local Function Patterns

Function-pattern groups are allowed as a special entry-file construct even though ordinary function declarations are forbidden. FoLang provides two entry-file forms with the same pattern-dispatch model but different capture semantics.

Bare Function-Pattern Group

A bare function-pattern group does not capture surrounding runtime bindings:

```
classify(0) => { "zero" }
classify(n).where(n > 0) => { "positive" }
classify(_) => { "negative" }
```

A bare group may use:

- its parameters and names introduced by its patterns
- its own name for recursion
- entry-local type names
- `co.*` APIs
- imported package and library APIs
- compile-time symbols that do not require runtime capture

It may not reference an entry-file runtime variable from the surrounding context:

```
offset := 100;

adjust(n) => { n + offset }
// compiler error: bare function-pattern groups cannot capture `offset`
```

Capturing `let` Function-Pattern Group

The `let` form exists only to declare an entry-local function-pattern group that captures one or more surrounding entry-file runtime bindings:

```
offset := 100;

let adjust(0) = offset
let adjust(n) = n + offset

result := adjust(10);
```

The captured names must resolve to surrounding runtime bindings that are already declared and definitely initialized before the first clause of the group. Built-in names, imported declarations, type names, parameters, and the function's own recursive name are not captures.

A `let` function-pattern group must capture at least one surrounding runtime binding. When no capture is required, the bare form must be used:

```
let fib(0) = 1
let fib(1) = 1
let fib(n) = fib(n - 1) + fib(n - 2)
// compiler error: this group captures nothing; remove `let`
```

```
fib(0) => { 1 }
fib(1) => { 1 }
fib(n) => { fib(n - 1) + fib(n - 2) }
```

The **let** marker is therefore not an optional spelling of a bare function-pattern group. It explicitly requests restricted lexical capture.

Similarities

Bare and capturing **let** function-pattern groups both:

- group compatible clauses by function name and arity
- dispatch by parameter patterns and optional **.where(...)** guards
- evaluate clauses in normal pattern-selection order
- may call themselves recursively
- must maintain compatible parameter and result types across all clauses
- follow the normal pattern ordering, reachability, overlap, and exhaustiveness rules
- are private to the entry file
- cannot be imported, exported, or annotated with package visibility
- cannot be converted to, assigned as, passed as, or returned as function values
- cannot be partially applied or curried

Differences

Form	Surrounding runtime capture	Intended use
name(pattern) => body	No	Entry-local pattern dispatch that depends only on its arguments, recursion, built-ins, imports, and compile-time names
let name(pattern) = body	Yes, at least one capture required	Entry-local pattern dispatch that also depends on existing entry-file runtime bindings

Clauses of the same name and arity must all use the same form. Mixing bare and **let** clauses in one function-pattern group is a compiler error.

A capturing **let** function-pattern group is still not a general closure facility. It is named, entry-local, non-first-class, and non-escaping. The compiler may internally retain a capture environment, but FoLang does not expose that environment as a closure object.

let cannot be used directly in the entry file for value bindings, anonymous functions, general closure expressions, or curried functions:

```
let base = 10;           // compiler error: entry-file let value binding
let result = base + 1;   // compiler error: entry-file let value binding
let add = (a, b) => a + b; // compiler error: anonymous function
let counter = closure { ... }; // compiler error: general closure expression
let add = a => b => a + b; // compiler error: curried function
```

The compiler may lower either function-pattern form to a private entry helper, but neither source construct is a general-purpose function declaration.

Forbidden Entry-File Constructs

The following constructs are forbidden directly in the application entry file:

- ordinary named function declarations
- anonymous functions and function literals
- general closure declarations and first-class closure values
- curried or partially applied function declarations
- classes
- structs
- cstructs
- enums
- unions and ADT constructor declarations
- type classes and type-class instances
- user-defined type constructors
- generic declarations
- macros
- templates
- units and companion units
- modules
- custom matchers
- indexers
- extensions
- user-defined annotations
- decorators
- custom operators
- interfaces and signatures
- objects
- package declarations
- library declarations
- any declaration intended to be imported or exported

File directives such as `@co.ddap.import`, `@co.ddap.alias`, and `@co.ddap.dynamicruntime` are not user-defined annotations or decorators and remain permitted where their own rules allow them.

Entry-File Dependency Direction

The entry file may depend on packages and libraries, but packages and libraries may never depend on the entry context:

```
application entry file
  ↓ uses
packages and libraries
```

This allows the entry file to coordinate application startup while preserving package and library independence.

Library Project Layout

```
/hrlib/
├─ hrlib.fol           ← library surface – @co.dap.library
├─ emp/                package "emp" – internal, invisible to consumer
│   ├─ Employee.fol
│   └─ EmpService.fol
└─ auth/               package "auth" – internal, invisible to consumer
    ├─ Auth.fol
    └─ AuthService.fol
```

Consumer only sees what `hrlib.fol` declares. All subfolders are internal.

Package Access Rules

Four access levels control visibility across package boundaries:

Annotation	Same Package	Parent	Sub-Package	Unrelated	Entry / Surface
<code>@co.dap.public</code>	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
<code>@co.dap.package</code>	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗
<code>@co.dap.protected</code>	✓	✗	✓	✗	✗
<code>@co.dap.private</code>	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗

Meaning:

- `@co.dap.public` -> visible everywhere
- `@co.dap.package` -> visible across the package family
- `@co.dap.protected` -> visible downward into subpackages only
- `@co.dap.private` -> visible only inside the declaring package

Example:

```
// hr/EmployeeAccess.fol - package "hr"

@co.dap.public
EmployeeAccess co.lang.unit = {

    @co.dap.public
    getEmployee(id co.lang.int)->(Employee) = { ... }    // anyone can call

    @co.dap.package
    validateId(id co.lang.int)->(co.lang.bool) = { ... } // hr package family

    @co.dap.protected
    baseQuery()->(co.lang.string) = { ... }              // visible to subpackages

    @co.dap.private
    normalizeId(id co.lang.int)->(co.lang.int) = { ... } // private declaration
}
```

`co.*` Paths and Aliases

`co.*` Is Always Available

All `co.*` paths are part of the language and are always in scope. They are never imported through `@co.ddap.import`.

```
co.out.println("hello")
co.in.readln()
x co.lang.int = 42;
```

Being **in scope** does not automatically mean **permitted in every context**.

A package rule, library kind, or other compiler restriction may still forbid use of a particular `co.*` facility. In such cases the name is still known to the compiler, but its use is rejected at compile time.

`@co.ddap.alias`

Use aliases only to shorten `co.*` paths.

```
@co.ddap.alias(co.out, as="out")
@co.ddap.alias(co.core.list, as="list")
@co.ddap.alias(co.encoding, as="enc")

out.println("hello")
list.of(1, 2, 3)
enc.json.serialize(data)

// full form still works alongside
co.out.println("world")
```

Rules:

- target must be a `co.*` path
- alias must be a valid identifier
- alias scope is file-local
- aliasing user packages is not allowed; use `as=` in `@co.ddap.import`
- duplicate aliases in the same file are compiler errors
- when no alias is declared, the complete `co.*` path is used
- declaring an alias does not disable or hide the complete `co.*` path

Imports

FoLang supports three import forms. User packages and libraries must be imported before use. When an import declares `as=`, symbols are accessed through that alias. When `as=` is omitted, the complete imported package or library path is used.

1. Normal Package Import

Use this for ordinary project packages.

```
@co.ddap.import(package="hr.employee", as="emp")

e := emp.getEmployee(1);
co.out.println(e.name);
```

Resolution:

```
package="hr.employee" -> /appl/hr/employee/
```

2. Source Library Import

Use this for same-owner workspace libraries whose source is available.

```
@co.ddap.import(package="com.abc.ffi", library=true, expect="ffi", as="ffilib")
```

Resolution:

```
package="com.abc.ffi", library=true -> /appl/com/abc/ffi.fo1
```


The resolved file must be a library surface file:

```
@co.dap.library(type="ffi")
ffilib co.lang.library={

}
```

Meaning:

- `package` gives the logical library path
- `library=true` means the leaf resolves to a single `.fol` surface file, not a folder
- `expect` is an import-site assertion; the compiler checks it against the actual library type
- only the projected surface API is visible; internal sources are not importable through normal package imports

3. Packaged Library Import

Use this for third-party or prebuilt libraries.

```
@co.ddap.import(library="hrlib", as="hr")
@co.ddap.import(library="paylib", as="pay")
```

Resolution:

```
library="hrlib" -> libs/hrlib.folenc, else libs/hrlib.folib
```

Only the packaged library's projected surface API is visible to the consumer.

Import Directive Fields

Field	Required	Default	Meaning
<code>package</code> or <code>library</code>	one required	—	logical package path or packaged library name
<code>library</code>	✗	<code>false</code>	when <code>true</code> , <code>package=</code> resolves to a source library surface file
<code>expect</code>	✗	inferred from library surface	expected library kind such as <code>ffi</code> , <code>system</code> , <code>advanced</code> , <code>dynamicvmrt</code> , or <code>application</code>
<code>as</code>	✗	none — full dot path required when omitted	local alias; valid FoLang identifier
<code>realm</code>	✗	<code>app</code>	isolation domain
<code>parent-realm</code>	✗	—	realm shadowing relationship

Notes:

- `as` is optional — when omitted, no short alias is created and the full imported package path must be used to access symbols
- dots are not allowed in `as`
- `expect` is validation, not the source of truth
- the source of truth is `@co.dap.library(type="...")` on the resolved surface file

Examples:

```
@co.ddap.import(package="hr.employee", as="emp")
emp.Employee

@co.ddap.import(package="hr.employee")
hr.employee.Employee
```

Valid `as` Values

```
as="hr"           ✓
as="v1_hr"        ✓
as="v1.hr"        ✗
as="123hr"        ✗
```

Library Surfaces

FoLang uses surface files in two situations:

1. **Packaged library project surfaces**
2. **Application-workspace source library surfaces**

A surface file is a special source form annotated with `@co.dap.library`. It defines one library identity, its public boundary data contracts, and the boundary-adaptor functions through which consumers call the library.

```
app.fol    -> application entry
hrlib.fol  -> packaged library surface
ffi.fol    -> source library surface when imported with library=true
```

A library surface is not an ordinary package file. It may contain multiple boundary data declarations and public functions inside one `co.lang.library` declaration.

Packaged Library Project Surface

A packaged library project has no application entry file. It has exactly one surface file at the project root.

```
/hrlib/
├─ hrlib.fol           <- library surface
├─ emp/                <- internal package
│   └─ Employee.fol
│       └─ EmployeeService.fol
└─ auth/               <- internal package
    └─ AuthService.fol
```

Rules:

- exactly one `@co.dap.library` surface file exists per packaged library project
- the surface file is located at the project root
- it is compiled into the packaged library artifact, such as `.folib` or `.folenc`
- consumers import it with `@co.ddap.import(library="...")`
- internal package folders are compiled into the library but are not directly visible to consumers

Application-Workspace Source Library Surface

A source library may live inside an application workspace.

```
@co.ddap.import(
  package="com.abc.ffi",
  library=true,
  expect="ffi",
  as="ffilib"
)
```

The import resolves to one surface file:

```
/appl/com/abc/ffi.fo1
```

Rules:

- a source-library surface file must be below the application root, never at the application root
- multiple source libraries may exist in one application workspace
- the surface is imported through `package="..."` with `library=true`
- only the projected surface API is importable
- internal packages remain hidden even though their source files are physically available
- once a source tree is treated as a library, its subpackages cannot be imported as ordinary packages by consumers
- packaged libraries and source libraries use exactly the same public-surface and API-projection rules

Unified Surface Model

Every library kind uses the same conceptual surface shape:

```
library surface
├─ boundary data contracts
└─ public boundary-adapter functions
```

Library kind changes the permitted boundary representation and transfer semantics, not the conceptual form of the API.

Library kind	Boundary data	Transfer semantics
application	co.lang.struct	automatic deep snapshot
dynamicvmrt	co.lang.struct	automatic deep snapshot
advanced	co.lang.struct	automatic deep snapshot
system	co.lang.cstruct	system ABI value
ffi	co.lang.cstruct	C ABI value

`co.lang.struct` and `co.lang.cstruct` solve different problems:

```
struct  -> FoLang semantic data contract
cstruct -> physical ABI-compatible value contract
```

Value transfer must not be confused with C-compatible layout. Application-family libraries therefore use expressive `struct` contracts transferred as deep snapshots, while system and FFI libraries use restricted `cstruct` contracts.

Allowed Surface Declarations

A library surface may contain only:

- file- or library-level imports needed by its adapter implementations
- `co.lang.struct` boundary declarations for `application`, `dynamicvmrt`, and `advanced`
- `co.lang.cstruct` boundary declarations for `system` and `ffi`
- public free-function API declarations with boundary-adapter definitions

The following declaration kinds are forbidden directly in every library surface:

- classes
- modules
- interfaces
- signatures
- units and companion units
- associated functions
- operator functions
- enums, unions, and other ADTs
- type aliases, newtypes, and opaque types
- objects, instances, type classes, and dependent types
- macros, templates, annotations, and decorators
- global variables, pointers, references, addresses, or mutable surface state

Surface `struct` and `cstruct` declarations are data contracts only. They cannot have companion units, associated functions, operators, methods, or other behavior on the surface.

Declarations directly inside the `co.lang.library` body are exported by default. Imports and implementation details are never exported.

Public Signature Type Closure

Every public surface function signature must be closed over the library's exported boundary type set.

For `application`, `dynamicvmrt`, and `advanced` surfaces, parameters and results may use only:

- approved built-in types
- `co.lang.struct` types declared in the same library surface

For `system` and `ffi` surfaces, parameters and results may use only:

- ABI-safe built-in types
- `co.lang.cstruct` types declared in the same library surface

The same closure rule applies recursively to fields of surface boundary types:

- a surface `struct` field may use an approved built-in type or another surface-declared `struct`
- a surface `cstruct` field may use an ABI-safe built-in type or another surface-declared `cstruct`
- an internal package type may never appear in a public function signature or surface boundary-type field
- pointers, references, and addresses may never cross any public library surface

A built-in type is not automatically surface-safe merely because it belongs to `co.lang`. An approved surface built-in must be concrete, fully resolved, and transferable under the library kind's boundary semantics.

The following categories are forbidden in public surface fields and signatures:

- inference-only types such as `co.lang.auto` and `co.lang.infer`
- dynamically typed or unconstrained carriers such as `co.lang.dynamic`, `co.lang.any`, `co.lang.typed`, and `co.lang.untyped`
- function, closure, delegate, loader, realm, AST, reflection, or runtime implementation values
- pointer, reference, address, thunk, and implementation-handle types
- any type whose reachable representation contains a forbidden type

For application-family surfaces, managed built-ins such as `co.lang.string` are permitted when the compiler defines deep-snapshot reconstruction for them. For system and FFI surfaces, only built-ins with a defined ABI representation are permitted; for example, `co.lang.string` is not directly cstruct-compatible.

Valid:

```
Employee co.lang.struct = {
  id      co.lang.int;
  name    co.lang.string;
  address Address;
}

Address co.lang.struct = {
  city co.lang.string;
}
```

Invalid:

```
getEmployee(id co.lang.int)->(emp.internal.Employee);
// compiler error: an internal type escapes through the public signature
```

Boundary-Adapter Functions

A public surface function may contain a definition, but its definition is restricted to boundary adaptation.

A boundary-adapter function may:

- read its input parameters and their fields
- declare temporary local values used only for conversion
- construct internal input values
- perform deterministic field-to-field or representation conversion
- invoke exactly one internal implementation operation
- receive that operation's result
- construct and return an allowed surface `struct`, surface `cstruct`, or built-in value
- use a direct delegation expression when no conversion is required

A boundary-adapter function may not:

- implement business rules or domain calculations
- perform business validation or authorization decisions
- orchestrate multiple implementation operations
- call another surface function
- perform persistence, networking, file I/O, retries, caching, or transactions
- start concurrency, scheduling, asynchronous work, processes, or continuations
- contain loops, recursion, workflow branching, or externally observable state mutation
- expose an internal value directly without converting it to an allowed boundary type

The compiler enforces the restricted adapter statement set. The restriction is structural: arbitrary executable logic is not accepted merely because it is placed in a surface file.

A direct delegate is the simplest adapter form:

```
health()->(co.lang.bool)
=> health.internal.Service.health();
```

A converting adapter may map between the public contract and an internal model.

Application Surface Example

```
// hrlib.fol
@co.dap.library(type="application")
hrlib co.lang.library = {

    @co.ddap.import(package="emp", as="emp")

    Employee co.lang.struct = {
        name co.lang.string;
        id   co.lang.int;
    }

    getEmployee(empId co.lang.int)->(Employee) = {
        internalEmployee := emp.EmployeeService.getEmployee(empId);

        this.return Employee{
            name: internalEmployee.name,
            id: internalEmployee.id
        };
    }
}
```

The surface owns conversion from the internal `emp.Employee` representation to the public `hrlib.Employee` contract. The `emp` package owns validation, business rules, persistence, and workflow.

The consumer sees the equivalent API contract:

```
Employee co.lang.struct = {
    name co.lang.string;
    id   co.lang.int;
}

getEmployee(empId co.lang.int)->(Employee);
```

The consumer does not see the body of `getEmployee` or the `emp` package.

System and FFI Surface Example

```
// driver.fol
@co.dap.library(type="system")
driver co.lang.library = {

    @co.ddap.import(package="driver.internal", as="impl")

    Point co.lang.cstruct = {
        x co.lang.int32;
        y co.lang.int32;
    }

    getOrigin()->(Point) = {
        internalPoint := impl.DriverService.getOrigin();

        this.return Point{
            x: internalPoint.x,
            y: internalPoint.y
        };
    }
}
```

```

    };
  }
}

```

Pointers, addresses, native bindings, and hardware state belong in `driver.internal`. They are forbidden in the public surface and cannot appear in the exported signature.

Boundary Transfer Semantics

For `application`, `dynamicvmrt`, and `advanced` libraries:

```

consumer boundary value
  ↓ automatic deep snapshot of the complete reachable value graph
library-local built-in or surface struct
  ↓ surface conversion
internal implementation value
  ↓ surface conversion
library-local built-in or surface struct
  ↓ automatic deep snapshot
consumer-local boundary value

```

The snapshot rule applies to both surface structs and approved built-in arguments/results. The library never receives the consumer's live object identity, and the consumer never receives a live internal-library object.

For `system` libraries, `cstruct` values cross according to the selected backend/platform system ABI.

For `ffi` libraries, `cstruct` values cross according to the declared C ABI, including its layout, alignment, and calling-convention requirements.

Surface-to-Internal Dependency Direction

The source-level dependency is one-way:

```

library surface
  ↓ imports and invokes
internal packages

```

Internal packages:

- do not import the library surface
- do not use surface-declared `struct` or `cstruct` types
- define their own implementation and domain types
- return internal values to the surface adapter
- contain all business logic, validation, workflow, I/O, and state management

This prevents a surface/internal compilation cycle and keeps the public contract independent from the internal domain model.

An internal implementation symbol may be visible to its own library surface without becoming part of the consumer API. Library encapsulation takes precedence over ordinary package visibility: consumers cannot resolve internal package symbols even when those symbols are callable from the surface during library compilation.

Consumer API Projection

The compiler does not expose the complete surface compilation context to a consumer. It creates a projected imported symbol table.

The projected API contains:

- the library identity and kind
- complete public surface `struct` or `cstruct` definitions, including field names and permitted field types
- public function names
- public function parameter names and types
- public function result types
- calling-convention, effect, error, and linkage metadata where applicable

The projected API does not contain:

- function bodies or implementation AST/HIR
- imports used by the surface
- local conversion variables
- delegate or implementation targets
- internal package paths or symbols
- private compiler-generated helpers
- business classes, modules, units, or internal data types

Therefore, a function definition may exist in the surface source and compiled artifact while the consumer's symbol table contains only its signature.

The backend may retain implementation bodies for code generation, linking, or whole-program optimization. Backend possession of implementation code does not make that code semantically visible to the consumer.

Source libraries follow the same rule. Availability of source code does not weaken the projected API boundary.

Library Compilation Order

A library is processed in four logical stages:

1. parse the surface header, boundary data declarations, and public function signatures
2. compile internal packages without depending on surface types
3. type-check and link surface boundary-adapter bodies against internal package symbols
4. emit the compiled implementation and the projected consumer API

This order permits the surface to call internal packages while preventing internal packages from depending on the surface.

Library Kinds

Library kinds are declared on the surface file:

```
@co.dap.library(type="ffi")
@co.dap.library(type="system")
@co.dap.library(type="dynamicvmrt")
@co.dap.library(type="advanced")
@co.dap.library(type="application")
```

Shared Meaning

- `application` -> ordinary safe library implementation
- `dynamicvmrt` -> application features plus full `co.meta` dynamic-runtime support
- `advanced` -> macro, template, concurrency, transformation, and runtime-machinery implementation
- `system` -> unsafe low-level runtime, pointer, process, native, and platform-control implementation
- `ffi` -> foreign-interface implementation

Library kind controls internal capabilities. All kinds still expose only boundary data contracts and public boundary-adapter functions.

application Libraries

Internally allowed:

- ordinary safe language features
- classes, modules, interfaces, signatures, units, and ordinary structs
- normal application-level packages and libraries

Internally forbidden:

- pointers, references, and addresses
- native functions annotated with `@co.dap.native`
- macros and templates
- low-level concurrency machinery
- advanced transformation or dynamic-runtime machinery

Public boundary:

- surface `struct` contracts
- approved built-in types
- deep-snapshot transfer

dynamicvmrt Libraries

Internally allowed:

- all `application` capabilities
- full `co.meta` support
- runtime reflection, instrumentation, dynamic loading, patching, and eval-based facilities

Internally forbidden:

- system and FFI capabilities unless reached through an imported public library surface
- raw pointers, addresses, and native functions in its own implementation

Public boundary:

- surface `struct` contracts
- approved built-in types
- deep-snapshot transfer

advanced Libraries

Internally allowed:

- all ordinary safe language features
- macros and templates
- `async`, `parallel`, `continuation`, `scheduling`, and `transformation` machinery
- compiler/runtime behavior definitions permitted to advanced libraries

Internally forbidden:

- raw pointers
- references and addresses
- native functions

Public boundary:

- surface `struct` contracts
- approved built-in types
- deep-snapshot transfer

system Libraries

Internally allowed:

- pointers, references, addresses, and word-level types
- native functions
- structs and cstructs
- units containing free functions
- basic value-typed functions
- type aliases
- basic threading and process primitives

Internally forbidden:

- classes
- modules
- interfaces and signatures
- overloading and overriding
- new operator definitions
- generics and templates
- macros
- reflection and dynamic runtime
- dependent types and type classes
- function patterns
- closures and currying
- advanced concurrency machinery such as continuations, defer, lazy evaluation, and thunks
- variadic, named, optional, and default parameters

Public boundary:

- surface `cstruct` contracts
- ABI-safe built-in types
- system ABI value transfer

ffi Libraries

Internally allowed:

- native and extern declarations
- pointers, references, addresses, and C ABI types
- cstructs and restricted implementation structs
- units containing free functions
- foreign calling-convention and symbol-linkage metadata

Internally forbidden:

- classes
- modules
- interfaces and signatures
- overloading and overriding
- new operator definitions
- generics and templates
- macros
- reflection and dynamic runtime
- dependent types and type classes
- closures, currying, and advanced concurrency machinery

Public boundary:

- surface `cstruct` contracts
- C-ABI-safe built-in types
- C ABI value transfer

Dependency Direction

Allowed dependency flow is one-way:

```

application
  ↓ through public surface APIs only
dynamicvmrt
  ↓ through public surface APIs only
advanced
  ↓ through public surface APIs only
system
  ↓ through public surface APIs only
ffi

```

A library may depend on a library at the same or a lower level only when the dependency does not create a cycle. Reverse dependencies are compiler errors.

Cross-Library Communication

From	To	Allowed?	Notes
application	dynamicvmrt	✓	projected public surface only
application	advanced	✓	projected public surface only
application	system	✓	projected public surface only
application	ffi	✓	projected public surface only
dynamicvmrt	advanced	✓	projected public surface only
dynamicvmrt	system	✓	projected public surface only
dynamicvmrt	ffi	✓	projected public surface only
dynamicvmrt	application	✗	reverse dependency
advanced	system	✓	projected public surface only
advanced	ffi	✓	projected public surface only
advanced	application	✗	reverse dependency
advanced	dynamicvmrt	✗	reverse dependency
system	ffi	✓	projected public surface only
system	application	✗	reverse dependency
system	dynamicvmrt	✗	reverse dependency
system	advanced	✗	reverse dependency
ffi	application	✗	reverse dependency
ffi	dynamicvmrt	✗	reverse dependency
ffi	advanced	✗	reverse dependency
ffi	system	✗	reverse dependency

Realms

Realms provide import isolation, coexistence of versions, and controlled shadowing.

Realm declarations are always syntactically valid — you can always write `realm=` on any import. However realm isolation is **active only when the library marked with `dynamicvmrt`**. Without it, realm declarations are accepted but silently ignored and all imports behave as a single `app` realm.

Default realm:

```
app
```

Hierarchy example:

```
core
├── app
│   ├── app1
│   │   └── app3
│   └── app2
```

Rules:

- `realm` defaults to `app`
- if `parent-realm` is omitted, parent defaults to `app`
- `parent-realm` is meaningful only when `realm` is explicitly provided and is not `app`
- libraries are always static
- `@co.ddap.dynamicruntime` is allowed only on the application entry file

Version Coexistence

```
@co.ddap.import(package="hr", realm="app", as="hr")
@co.ddap.import(package="v1.hr", realm="x", as="v1_hr")
```

Shadowing

```
@co.ddap.import(package="a", realm="app", as="hr")
@co.ddap.import(package="a", realm="x", parent-realm="app", as="hr")
```

When the alias is the same and the child realm points to the parent realm, the child shadows the parent.

Import Binding Rules

Invalid

Same alias, same realm, different package:

```
@co.ddap.import(package="a", realm="app", as="hr")
@co.ddap.import(package="b", realm="app", as="hr") // error
```

Valid aggregation

```
@co.ddap.import(package="folderx.some", realm="app", as="hr")
@co.ddap.import(package="folderx.some", realm="app", as="hr")
```

Valid coexistence

```
@co.ddap.import(package="a", realm="app", as="hr")
@co.ddap.import(package="a", realm="x", as="v1_hr")
```

Valid shadowing

```
@co.ddap.import(package="a", realm="app", as="hr")
@co.ddap.import(package="a", realm="x", parent-realm="app", as="hr")
```

Cycles

Compiler error if any cycle exists through:

- package imports
- realm parent relationships

Examples:

- `packageA` imports `packageB`, and `packageB` imports `packageA`
- `realm="x", parent-realm="y"` and another import uses `realm="y", parent-realm="x"`

Symbol Resolution

Resolution Order

For symbols without a prefix:

1. current package symbol table
2. parent package chain upward
3. error if not found

For symbols with an alias prefix:

1. current package imported-context map
2. parent package chain imported-context maps
3. error if not found

For imports declared **without** `as`:

1. use the full imported package path directly
2. resolve it through imported-context lookup using that full path
3. error if not found

Example Context Graph

```
pp1 (grandparent package)
  └─ SymbolTable
  └─ ImportedContexts
```

```

└─ ChildCtxs

p1 (parent package)
├─ Parent -> &pp1
├─ SymbolTable
├─ ImportedContexts
└─ ChildCtxs

c1 (current package)
├─ Parent -> &p1
├─ SymbolTable
├─ ImportedContexts
└─ ChildCtxs

```

Resolution Examples

```

lookup "OwnType"
  -> current symbol table

lookup "ParentType"
  -> parent chain

lookup "hr.Employee"
  -> imported-context lookup for alias "hr"

lookup "hr.employee.Employee"
  -> imported-context lookup for full imported package path when no alias exists

lookup "unknown.Type"
  -> imported-context lookup fails -> compiler error

```

Short Summary

- folders define packages
- root is never a package
- each ordinary package source file has exactly one primary top-level declaration
- free functions in package source files must be enclosed in a `co.lang.unit`
- the application entry file is an executable, non-package context with its own restricted declaration rules
- entry-local type aliases, newtypes, opaque types, dependent-type aliases/usages, subtypes, supertypes, bare function-pattern groups, and capturing `let` function-pattern groups are allowed
- ordinary `let` value bindings, ordinary functions, anonymous functions, general closures, classes, structs, enums, cstructs, type constructors, generics, macros, templates, units, and reusable behavioral declarations are forbidden in the entry file
- `co.*` is always available and never imported
- `@co.ddap.alias` optionally shortens a `co.*` path; otherwise the complete path is used
- `@co.ddap.import(package="...")` imports normal packages
- `@co.ddap.import(package="...", library=true, ...)` imports same-owner source libraries
- `@co.ddap.import(library="...")` imports packaged external libraries
- `expect="..."` is an import-site assertion, not the source of truth
- `@co.dap.library(type="...")` is the source of truth for library kind
- every library surface exports only boundary `struct/cstruct` contracts and public function signatures
- surface function bodies are restricted boundary adapters and are hidden from consumer symbol tables
- application-family boundary structs cross by automatic deep snapshot
- system and FFI boundary cstructs cross by ABI value
- internal packages never depend on surface types; the surface converts between public and internal representations

Operators

Arithmetic operators

`+, -, *, /, %, **, ++, --`

Logical operators

`&&, ||, !, &, |`

Comparison operators

`==, !=, <, >, <=, >=`

Other operators

`@, #, !, ~, $, ^, (, ), _ ` , ? , { , [,] , } , \ , : , ; , " , ' , = , . , ? = , : = , :: = , , , . . . , < . . , . . < , < . . < , = > > , = > , - > , < - , - > > , < - >`

Reserved words

`co, let, this, self` (contextual keyword), `for, forall, fo` (reserved word)

Difference between `this` and `self`

- `this` is for instances and objects
- `self` is for classes
- `static` — no shortcut; can be on variable or classname
- Both `self` and `this` can access member variables

Custom Operator Definition & Overloading

Operator functions are functions and cannot be declared loose at package scope. An operator function for a struct must be declared inside that struct's same-package companion unit.

The **first declared operand parameter** must have the matching struct type. A matching struct type in a later operand is insufficient. For a unary operator, the sole operand must have the matching struct type.

For infix operators, this makes the first parameter the ownership or left-operand type used for companion-unit lookup. For example, an operator in `Vector co.lang.unit` may define `Vector * scalar`, but it may not define `scalar * Vector` unless that operation is owned and provided by the scalar type's applicable implementation.

```
Employee co.lang.struct = {
  salary co.lang.int;
}

Employee co.lang.unit = {

  @co.dap.operator(symbol='+', mode=overload)
  add(a Employee, b Employee)->(Employee) = {
    this.return Employee{
      salary: a.salary + b.salary
    };
  }
}
```

The expression:

```
combined := first + second;
```

is resolved through the `Employee` companion unit.

```
Vector co.lang.struct = {
  x co.lang.float;
  y co.lang.float;
}

Vector co.lang.unit = {
  @co.dap.operator(
    symbol='U',
    mode=define,
    fixity=infix,
    precedence=60,
    associativity=left,
    arity=binary,
    commutative=true,
    idempotent=true,
    identity="∅",
    foldable=true,
    vectorizable=false,
    distributes_over=['n'],
    desugar="intrinsic:set_union"
  )
  union(left Vector, right Vector)->(Vector) = {
    ...
  }
}
```

Invalid placement and ownership:

```
@co.dap.operator(symbol='+', mode=overload)
add(a Employee, b Employee)->(Employee) = { ... }
// ✖ operator function cannot appear at package scope

Math co.lang.unit = {
  @co.dap.operator(symbol='+', mode=overload)
  add(a Employee, b Employee)->(Employee) = { ... }
  // ✖ Math is not the companion unit of Employee
}

Employee co.lang.unit = {
  @co.dap.operator(symbol='+', mode=overload)
  add(a co.lang.int, b Employee)->(Employee) = { ... }
  // ✖ first operand is not Employee; a later matching operand is insufficient
}
```

`mode=override` is not supported in the foreseeable future; the compiler reports an error.

fixity values: `infix`, `postfix`, `prefix`, `circumfix`, `postcircumfix`, `prescircumfix`, `mixfix`, `ternary`, `distfix`

Variable Declaration

```
someVar co.lang.int;
someString co.lang.string;
```


With Initialization

```
someBool co.lang.bool = co.const.true;
someInt co.lang.int = 42;
```

With Type Inference

```
someVal := "Hello, World!";
someNum := 3.14; // if not defined, define and initialize; else throws error
someR ?= "Kamesh"; // if not defined, define and initialize; else reassign
```

Pointer Declaration

```
somePtr    co.lang.int->>(*);
someDblPtr co.lang.int->(**);
```

Array Declaration

```
someArray    co.lang.int->([5]);
someDblArray co.lang.int->([2,3]);
someJaggedArray co.lang.int->([2][3]);
someVLAArray co.lang.int->([...]);
someZeroLA    co.lang.int->([0]);
someZeroDimA  co.lang.int->([.]);
```

Array Declaration with Initialization

```
someInitializedArray co.lang.int->([3]) = [1, 2, 3];
someInitializedArray1 co.lang.int->([ ]) = [1, 2, 3];
someInitializedDblArray co.lang.int->([,]) = [[1, 2], [3, 4]];
```

Reference Declaration

```
someRef      co.lang.int->(&); // reference
someLValueRef co.lang.int->(&&); // LValue reference
someHpRef     co.lang.int->(~); // heap allocated reference
someAddr      co.lang.int->(@); // address
someThunk     co.lang.int->(^); // thunk
someSlice     co.lang.int->[:]); // slice
```

Range Declaration

```
// Typed range variable declaration
someRange co.lang.int->(..);

// Inferred range declarations
rangeI := 1..10; // [1, 10] ExcludeStart=false, ExcludeEnd=false
rangeS := 0<..5; // (0, 5] ExcludeStart=true, ExcludeEnd=false
```

```

rangeL := 0..<100;    // [0, 100) ExcludeStart=false, ExcludeEnd=true
rangeB := 0<..<100;   // (0, 100) ExcludeStart=true, ExcludeEnd=true
rangeE := ..100;     // open lower bound (_, 100]
rangeF := 1..;       // open upper bound [1, _)

```

Auto and Dynamic Variable Declaration

```

someAutoVar    co.lang.auto    = "Hello"; // type inferred from value; initialization required
someDynamicVar co.lang.dynamic;           // dynamic typing

```

Values

```

someVar co.lang.data = 10; // initialization required

```

Bind Variables

`$_[0-9]*`

Discard / Wildcard Variable

—

Comma and Grouping

```

// Comma
x co.lang.int = 10, y co.lang.string = "Hello", z co.lang.bool = co.const.true;

// Grouping
(x co.lang.int = 10, y co.lang.string = "Hello", z co.lang.bool = co.const.true);

```

Fat Pointers

```

x co.lang.int->(*, kind="", meta={});

co.lang.int->(*, meta={});

y co.lang.int->(*, meta={len:co.lang.usize, vtab:somepkg.VTable->(*)})

z co.lang.int->(*,kind=region, meta={})

```

```

Pointer
├─ base_type: T
├─ kind: <FatKind>
│   ├── thin
│   ├── slice
│   ├── relative
│   ├── trait
│   ├── buffer
│   ├── view
│   └─ opaque

```

```

|   |— custom
|   |— mem
|   |— nullptr
|   |— sptr
|   |— uptr
|   |— ptrdiff
|   |— usize
|   |— ssize
|   |— (region) ← optional syntactic sugar
|— meta:
   |— region: heap | stack | global | numa(N) | mmio | constant | ...
   |— len, cap, vtab, bits, endian, ...

```

Pointers for address manipulation

```

y co.lang.word->(repr=intptr);
z co.lang.word->(sign=unsigned, repr=uintptr);
p co.lang.word->(repr=ptrdiff);
n co.lang.word->(sign=unsigned, repr=usize);
m co.lang.word->(repr=isize);
o co.lang.void->(repr=nullptr);

```

Relative Pointers

```

z co.lang.int->(*,kind=relative, meta={})

```

Types and Kinds

```

x co.lang.int = 10;
x.type() → co.lang.int
x.kind() → co.lang.nothing

x co.lang.data = 10;
x.type()      → co.lang.value
x.kind()      → co.lang.data
x.type().type() → co.lang.int  // to get the actual type

x co.lang.auto = 10;
x.type() → co.lang.int  // inferred at compile time, static
x.kind() → co.lang.data

x co.lang.dynamic = 10;
x.type() → co.lang.int  // can vary at runtime
x.kind() → co.lang.data

```

Type Declarations

```

// Alias
x co.lang.type = co.lang.int;

// New
x co.lang.newtype = co.lang.int;

```

```
// Opaque
x co.lang.opaquetype = co.lang.int; //opaque types act like alias with base type from which they
declared and act like distinct type (new types) for others even when two opaque types derived from
same base types

// ADT (tagged union)
y co.lang.type = co.lang.int | co.lang.char;

// Subtype / covariant
test co.lang.subtype = co.lang.int;

// Supertype / contravariant
test co.lang.supertype = co.lang.int;
```

Dependent Types

Type Constructors — Functions That Return Types

A type constructor is a function that takes a value or type and returns a type. The returned type depends on the input value — this is what makes it a dependent type.

```
// Vector – type constructor function
// takes → co.lang.int (size)
// returns → co.lang.dependentType (a type)
Vector(n co.lang.int)->(co.lang.dependentType) =
    co.lang.int->([n]);

// calling Vector(3) returns a TYPE at compile time
// that type is co.lang.int->([3])
v3 Vector(3) = [1, 2, 3]; // type is Vector(3)
v4 Vector(4) = [1, 2, 3, 4]; // type is Vector(4) – different type!

// Vector(3) ≠ Vector(4) – completely different types
// size is part of the type – compiler knows at compile time
```

Type Constructor Is A Function

```
Vector      → function (type constructor)
Vector(3)   → function call → returns type co.lang.int->([3])
Vector(4)   → function call → returns type co.lang.int->([4])

just like:
    add(1, 2) → returns a value (3)
    Vector(3) → returns a type (int[3])
```

Compiler Enforced Size Safety

```
// dot product – only valid for same size vectors
// compiler enforces this via dependent types
dotProduct(a Vector(n), b Vector(n))->(co.lang.int) = {
    // n is same for both – compiler verified
}

v3 Vector(3) = [1, 2, 3];
```

```
v4 Vector(4) = [1, 2, 3, 4];

dotProduct(v3, v3)    //  same type Vector(3)
dotProduct(v3, v4)    //  compiler error – Vector(3) ≠ Vector(4)
```

Matrix — Two Parameter Type Constructor

```
// Matrix – takes rows and cols, returns dependent type
Matrix(r co.lang.int, c co.lang.int)->(co.lang.dependentType) =
  co.lang.int->([r, c]);

m34 Matrix(3, 4) = [[1,2,3,4],[5,6,7,8],[9,10,11,12]];
m45 Matrix(4, 5) = ...;

// matrix multiply – cols of A must equal rows of B
// n must match – compiler verified
multiply(a Matrix(r, n), b Matrix(n, c))->(Matrix(r, c)) = {
  // compiler ensures dimensions are compatible
}

multiply(m34, m45)    //  Matrix(3,4) × Matrix(4,5) = Matrix(3,5)
multiply(m34, m34)    //  compiler error – 4 ≠ 3
```

Stack — Value and Type Parameter

```
// Stack – takes size and element type
Stack(n co.lang.int, T co.lang.type)->(co.lang.dependentType) =
  T->([n]);

s Stack(10, co.lang.int)    = ...; // stack of max 10 ints
t Stack(5, co.lang.string) = ...; // stack of max 5 strings
```

Type Is Value + Kind Combined

```
Vector(3):
  kind  = Vector    (what it is)
  value = 3         (how many)
  type  = Vector(3) (both together – the dependent type)

Vector(3) ≠ Vector(4)  ← different types entirely
Vector(3) = Vector(3)  ← same type
```

Connects to Type Constructor in Spec

```
// Option – type constructor for ADT
@co.dap.hokrt
Option(T) co.lang.type = Some(T) | None();

// Vector – type constructor for dependent type
Vector(n co.lang.int)->(co.lang.dependentType) =
```

```
co.lang.int->([n]);

// same concept:
// Option(T) takes a type → returns ADT type
// Vector(n) takes a value → returns dependent type
```

Simple Dependent Type

```
identity(x co.lang.int)->(x.type) = x
```

Types Computed from Runtime Values

```
someType := somefun(value)

somefun(value co.lang.int)->(co.lang.type) = {
  (value < 100).return(co.lang.string).otherwise.return(co.lang.bool);
}

// or with annotation
@co.dap.typefromvalue
somefun(value co.lang.int)->(co.lang.type)={
  (value < 100).return("hello").otherwise.return(co.const.true);
}

// compile-time eager
@co.dap.comptime
@co.dap.eager
chooseType(value co.lang.int)->(co.lang.type) = {
  (value < 100).return(co.lang.string).otherwise.return(co.lang.bool);
}

// tagged value
somefun(value co.lang.int)->(co.lang.tag) = {
  (b < 100).return(co.lang.tag(co.lang.string, "Hello"))
    .otherwise.return(co.lang.tag(co.lang.bool, co.const.true));
}
```

Types

The three axes — each adds one new power:

Axis 1: Polymorphism (terms depend on types)

```
// "Give me a type, I'll give you a value"

// Without: write separate functions
identityInt(x int) → int
identityStr(x string) → string

// With: one function works for all types
```

```
identity(T)(x T) → T

// This is generics / parametric polymorphism
// System F, Java generics, your @co.dap.generic
```

Axis 2: Type operators (types depend on types)

```
// "Give me a type, I'll give you a type"

List(Int)    → List of Int      // type → type
Map(String, Int) → Map          // type → type → type
Option(T)    → Some(T) | None   // type constructor

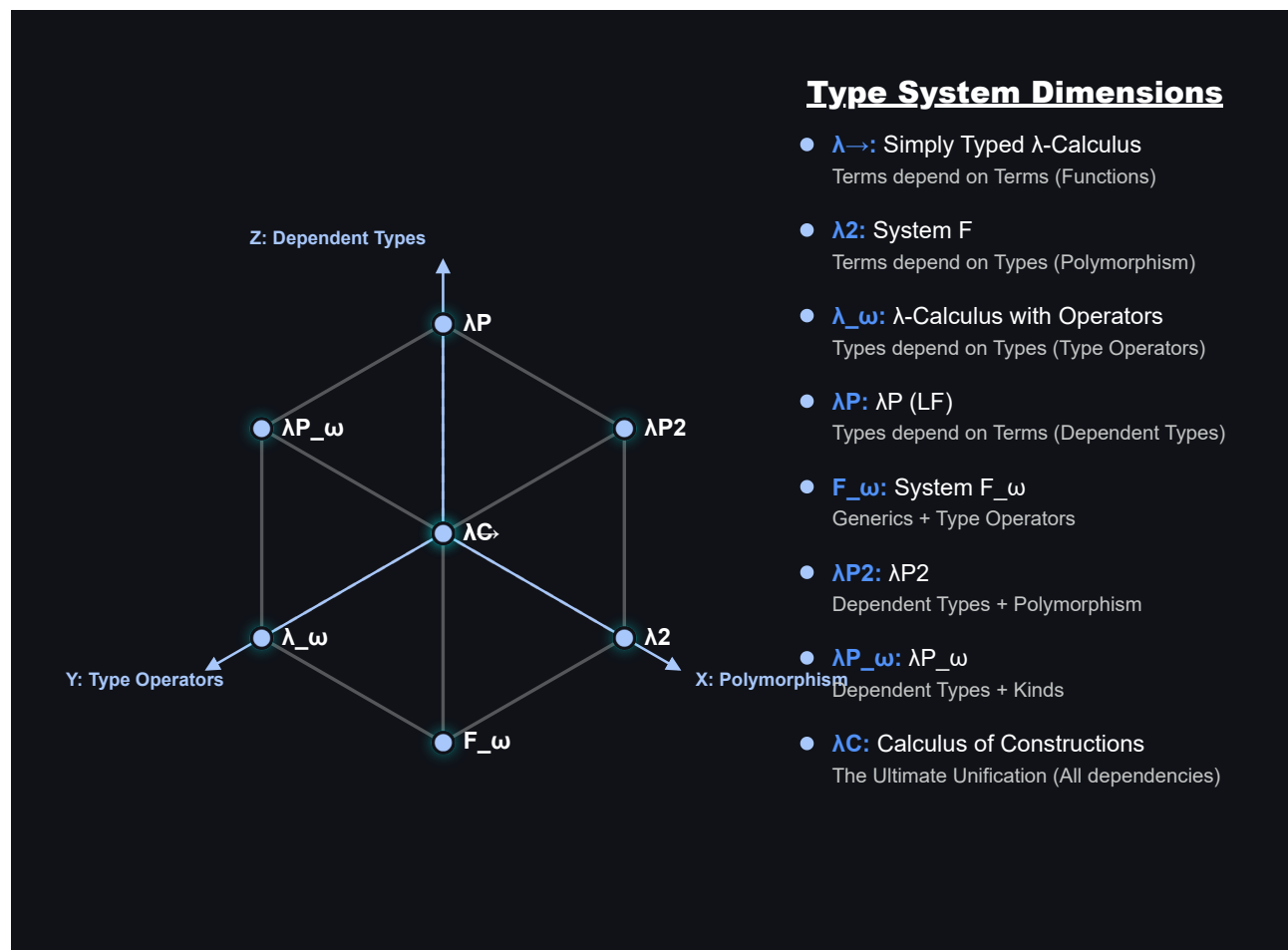
// This is kinds / higher-kinded types
// Your folang: Option(T) co.lang.type = Some(T) | None()
```

Axis 3: Dependent types (types depend on values)

```
// "Give me a value, I'll give you a type"

Vector(3)    → array of exactly 3 elements
Matrix(2, 3) → 2x3 matrix
NonZero(n)   → proof that n ≠ 0

// The type changes based on a runtime value
divide(a int, b NonZero(int)) → int
// compiler PROVES b can't be zero
```



Data Structures

Struct Declaration

```
myStruct co.lang.struct={
    field1 co.lang.int;
    field2 co.lang.string;
    field3 co.lang.bool;
}
```

Struct Rules

```
structs cannot extend other structs
structs cannot contain methods directly
structs can compose other structs
structs cannot have default values to fields/members
structs can embed other structs (Go lang like)
structs can have a same-package companion unit with the same name
receiverless companion-unit functions are static-like struct functions whose first parameter
matches the struct
associated functions in the companion unit are instance-method-like and use an explicit matching
receiver
operator functions for a struct must be declared in its companion unit and use the struct as their
first operand
```

The struct declaration remains pure data. All behaviour associated with a struct is declared separately in its matching `co.lang.unit`.

Struct Embedding

Embedding promotes fields of an embedded struct directly into the outer struct — they act as the outer struct's own fields at construction and access sites. This is distinct from composition where the embedded struct is a named field.

```
E co.lang.struct = {
    id co.lang.int;
    name co.lang.string;
}

// ✔ No conflict – id and name promoted as B's own fields
B co.lang.struct = {
    age co.lang.float;
    E; // embedded – id and name promoted
}

b := B{ age: 25.0, id: 1, name: "Rao" }; // all fields at same level
b.id // direct – no b.E.id needed
b.name // direct – no b.E.name needed
b.age // direct
```

```
// ✗ Compiler error – name conflict between B.name and E.name
B co.lang.struct = {
    name co.lang.string; // conflicts with E.name
    E;
```



```
    age co.lang.float;
}
// Fix 1 – rename B's conflicting field
// Fix 2 – use explicit composition instead: e E;

// Explicit composition – no promotion, always qualified access
B co.lang.struct = {
    name co.lang.string;
    e E;           // named field – no conflict, no promotion
    age co.lang.float;
}

b.name    // B's own name
b.e.id    // E's id – always explicit
b.e.name  // E's name – always explicit
```

Embedding Rules

Situation	Behavior
Embedded field, no conflict	Promoted — acts as the outer struct's own field
Embedded field, name conflict with outer	✗ Compiler error — rename or use composition
Multiple embeds, no conflict between them	All fields promoted
Multiple embeds, conflict between embedded structs	✗ Compiler error
Explicit composition (e E)	No promotion — always accessed via b.e.field

FoLang does **not** silently shadow conflicting fields. Any name conflict is a compiler error — the programmer must make a conscious decision to rename or switch to explicit composition.

Struct Inner Type Rules

```
structs can declare inner structs      ✓ data composing data
structs can declare inner enums/ADTs   ✓ data variant – natural
structs cannot declare inner classes   ✗ compiler error – struct is pure data
structs cannot declare inner modules   ✗ compiler error – struct is pure data

// ✓ valid – struct declaring inner struct
Employee co.lang.struct = {
    Address co.lang.struct = {
        street co.lang.string;
        city co.lang.string;
    }
    id co.lang.int;
    name co.lang.string;
    address Address;
}

// ✓ valid – struct declaring inner enum
Employee co.lang.struct = {
    Status co.lang.enum = {
        Active,
        Inactive
    }
    id co.lang.int;
    status Status;
```

```

}

// ✗ compiler error – struct declaring inner class
Employee co.lang.struct = {
    Validator co.lang.class = { // ✗ struct is pure data
        validate()->(co.lang.bool) = { ... }
    }
    id co.lang.int;
}

```

C-Struct Declaration

`co.lang.cstruct` is a C-like value type — passed by value, simple memory layout, safe to cross zone boundaries. Unlike `co.lang.struct` which is passed by reference, `co.lang.cstruct` is always copied on pass.

```

Point co.lang.cstruct = {
    x co.lang.int;
    y co.lang.int;
}

Rect co.lang.cstruct = {
    origin Point;
    width  co.lang.int;
    height co.lang.int;
}

```

cstruct Rules

always passed by value – never by reference
 simple memory layout – no metadata
 can contain only simple types and other cstructs
 cannot contain `co.lang.struct` ✗ has metadata
 cannot contain `co.lang.string` ✗ heap allocated
 cannot contain `co.lang.dynamic` ✗ runtime type info
 cannot contain classes ✗ vtable, metadata
 cannot contain modules ✗
 cannot contain any heap allocated type ✗
 cannot have methods
 cannot have associated functions
 cannot embed `co.lang.struct`
 safe to cross direct ABI and zone boundaries

allowed field types:

<code>co.lang.int</code> , <code>co.lang.uint</code> , <code>co.lang.float</code>	✓	primitives
<code>co.lang.bool</code> , <code>co.lang.char</code> , <code>co.lang.byte</code>	✓	primitives
<code>co.lang.int->([N])</code>	✓	fixed size arrays
<code>co.lang.cstruct</code>	✓	other cstructs

Packed cstruct — no padding, exact memory layout

Used for hardware registers, binary protocols, exact memory mapped formats:

```

@co.dap.packed
Register co.lang.cstruct = {
    flags  co.lang.uint8;
    status co.lang.uint8;
}

```

```
data    co.lang.uint16;
}
```

SIMD cstruct — aligned for vector operations

Used for math, graphics, signal processing:

```
@co.dap.simd(align=16)
Vec4 co.lang.cstruct = {
    x co.lang.float;
    y co.lang.float;
    z co.lang.float;
    w co.lang.float;
}
```

Both together

```
@co.dap.packed
@co.dap.simd(align=32)
AVXVec co.lang.cstruct = {
    data co.lang.float;
}
```

`@co.dap.packed` and `@co.dap.simd` are specialisations of `co.lang.cstruct` — same rules, same zone boundary safety. They are not separate types.

Enum Declaration

```
myEnum co.lang.enum={
    Variant1,
    Variant2,
    Variant3
}
```

Union Declaration

```
myUnion co.lang.union={
    intValue co.lang.int;
    strValue co.lang.string;
}
```

Classes

```
Employee co.lang.class ={
    getEmployeeDetails()->(Employee) = empmodule.getEmployeeDetails;
    // assigning module function to class's method

    getEmployeeInfo()->(Employee) =>> empmodule.getEmployeeDetails();
    // delegating – internally redirecting the call to module function
}
```

```
// $1, $2, $3 ... are previous results captured as bind variables
Emp co.lang.class={
  dosomething(a co.lang.int, b co.lang.int)->
  (co.lang.int)=>>somePack.someMethod(a)=>>someOthPack.someOtherMeth($1, b);
}
```

Inner Type Declaration Rules

Outer → Inner	Allowed?	Reason
class → struct	✓	data scoped to class — natural
class → class	✓	natural OOP nesting
class → enum/ADT	✓	variant scoped to class
class → module	✗	compiler error — module is standalone
struct → struct	✓	data composing data
struct → enum/ADT	✓	data variant — natural
struct → class	✗	compiler error — struct is pure data
struct → module	✗	compiler error — struct is pure data
module → struct	✓	data types for module functions
module → enum/ADT	✓	variants for module functions
module → class	✗	compiler error — module has no instances
module → module	✗	compiler error — use package nesting instead

```
Employee co.lang.class = {
  // ✓ inner struct – scoped to Employee
  Address co.lang.struct = {
    street co.lang.string;
    city   co.lang.string;
  }

  // ✓ inner ADT – scoped to Employee
  Status co.lang.type = Active | Inactive | Pending;

  address Address;
  status  Status;

  @co.dap.instance
  getAddress()->(Address) = { ... }
}

// accessing inner types from outside
a Employee.Address = Employee.Address{ street: "MG Road", city: "Mumbai" }
s Employee.Status  = Employee.Status.Active
```

Inner types follow the same access rules as methods – `@co.dap.private`, `@co.dap.public` etc. apply.

Method Types

```

```folang
Employee co.lang.class = {

 @co.dap.static
 getEmployee()->(Employee) = {}

 @co.dap.instance
 getEmployee()->(Employee) = {}

 @co.dap.class
 getEmployee()->(Employee) = {}

 @co.dap.object
 getEmployee()->(Employee) = {}
}

@co.dap.oops(
 A: { inherit:true, virtual:true },
 B: { implements:true },
 C: { inherits:true, abstract=true },
 D: { inherits:true },
 E: { uses:true },
 F: { composes:true },
 G: { extends:true },
 H: { with:true },
 I: { associate:true },
)
test co.lang.class = {
 getTest(id int)->(test) = {}
}

```

## The @@new and @@init Methods

`@@new` and `@@init` are lifecycle methods — compiler-owned, not user-definable outside the class. `@@` signals they are restricted lifecycle symbols, not regular methods.

```

@co.dap.generic(type={T:{typename}, R:{typename}})
Employee co.lang.class = {

 id T
 name R

 // @@new is provided by default even if not overridden.
 // Override only when you genuinely need to change allocation behavior.

 @co.dap.method.class
 @co.dap.private
 @@new()->(co.lang.uninit) = { self.return co.const.none }

 @co.dap.method.class
 @co.dap.public
 @@new(a co.lang.typevalue, b co.lang.typevalue)->(co.lang.uninit) = {
 // Manual type aliasing – @co.dap.generic handles this automatically
 // Override @@new only when you need custom allocation logic
 T co.lang.type = a
 R co.lang.type = b

 // self keyword is allowed only in class methods
 self.parent.@@new();
 }
}

```

```

 // uninit instance method internally calls @@new and @@init
 self.return co.lang.uninit.instance(Employee, self);
 }

 @co.dap.override
 @co.dap.constructor(access=private)
 @@init() = {}

 @co.dap.override
 @co.dap.constructor(access=public)
 @@init(id T, name R) = {
 this.parent.@@init();
 this.id = id;
 this.name = name;
 }

 getEmployee(id T)->(Employee) = {}
}

```

## Module Declaration

A module is an ML/OCaml-style abstraction that may be governed by a signature and may own type declarations as part of its contract. A module should not be introduced merely to prevent functions from appearing loose in a file; use `co.lang.unit` for that simpler structural purpose.

```

EmployeeModule co.lang.signature={
 // module contents
 getEmployee(id co.lang.int)->(Employee);
}

@co.dap.module(signature=EmployeeModule)
EmployeeModImpl co.lang.module->(signature=EmployeeModule, matches=EmployeeModule) = {

 Employee co.lang.struct={
 Id co.lang.int;
 Name co.lang.string;
 }

 getEmployee(id co.lang.int)->(Employee)={
 this.return Employee{
 Id:10, Name:"Rao",
 };
 }

}

mm EmployeeModule = EmployeeModuleImpl;
v mm.Employee = mm.Employee{Id:10, Name:"Rao"};
mm.getEmployee(10);

```

### Module Inner Type Rules

```

//  valid – module declaring inner struct
EmployeeModule co.lang.module = {

 Config co.lang.struct = {

```

```

 timeout co.lang.int;
 retries co.lang.int;
 }

 Status co.lang.enum = {
 Active,
 Inactive
 }

 connect(cfg Config)->(co.lang.bool) = { ... }
 getStatus()->(Status) = { ... }
}

// ✖ compiler error – module declaring inner class
EmployeeModule co.lang.module = {
 Validator co.lang.class = { // ✖ module has no instances
 validate()->(co.lang.bool) = { ... }
 }
}

// ✖ compiler error – module declaring inner module
EmployeeModule co.lang.module = {
 HelperModule co.lang.module = { } // ✖ use package nesting instead
}

```

## Unit Declaration

A **unit** is a named, non-instantiable container for functions.

Like other named primary declarations, a unit may use an explicit name or `_` for filename-derived naming. For example, `_co.lang.unit` in `Math.fol` declares `Math`, while an explicit name such as `Math co.lang.unit` is authoritative regardless of the filename.

Its purpose is structural: it prevents functions from flowing freely at package-file scope and preserves FoLang's rule that every ordinary package source file has one primary top-level declaration. A unit does **not** require its functions to form a domain model, capability, service, or other semantic abstraction.

Functions within a unit may be strongly related by purpose—for example, mathematical, parsing, encoding, or validation functions—or only loosely related. Semantic cohesion is encouraged as a source-design practice but is not enforced by the language.

A unit has two forms:

1. **Standalone unit** — its name does not match a struct in the same package. It acts as an ordinary named container for receiverless functions.
2. **Struct companion unit** — its name matches exactly one `co.lang.struct` in the same package. It provides behaviour associated with that struct while the struct declaration itself remains pure data.

Only `co.lang.struct` can have a companion unit. A same-name unit is not allowed for `co.lang.class`, `co.lang.cstruct`, modules, enums, unions, interfaces, signatures, or other declaration kinds. Classes already contain their own methods and lifecycle behaviour; `cstruct` remains a restricted C-compatible data representation.

```

Text co.lang.unit = {

 trim(value co.lang.string)->(co.lang.string) = {
 ...
 }

 contains(
 value co.lang.string,

```

```

 search co.lang.string
)->(co.lang.bool) = {
 ...
 }

 repeat(
 value co.lang.string,
 count co.lang.int
)->(co.lang.string) = {
 ...
 }
}

```

Unit functions are accessed through the unit name:

```

cleaned := Text.trim(input);
found := Text.contains(input, "FoLang");

```

A unit:

- introduces a named scope for its functions
- contains receiverless functions
- may additionally contain associated and operator functions when it is a struct companion unit
- requires the first declared parameter of every receiverless companion function to have the matching struct type
- uses the explicit receiver, rather than ordinary-parameter matching, to associate an associated function with its struct
- may contain public and private functions
- may use built-in types, user-defined types, or both
- does not introduce a user-defined data type or ADT
- has no fields or unit-level variables
- has no constructors or lifecycle methods
- has no instances, object identity, inheritance, or polymorphic dispatch
- cannot be instantiated or assigned as an object value
- cannot contain nested classes, structs, enums, modules, or other primary type declarations

Local declarations inside an individual unit function remain valid under the normal function-scoping rules.

```

General co.lang.unit = {

 parseNumber(value co.lang.string)->(co.lang.int) = { ... }

 clamp(
 value co.lang.int,
 min co.lang.int,
 max co.lang.int
)->(co.lang.int) = { ... }
}

```

The functions inside a unit do not need to use UDTs or ADTs. A unit is especially useful for small operations that consume built-in values, perform a computation, and return built-in values.

A unit may also represent a clearly related family of operations:

```

Math co.lang.unit = {

 abs(value co.lang.int)->(co.lang.int) = { ... }
}

```



```

 max(
 a co.lang.int,
 b co.lang.int
)->(co.lang.int) = { ... }

 sqrt(value co.lang.float)->(co.lang.float) = { ... }
}

```

The common purpose of these functions makes the source easier to understand, but the compiler does not require or attempt to prove that all functions in a unit are semantically related.

## Struct Companion Units

When a unit has the same name as a struct in the same package, it is the companion unit of that struct.

The struct and its companion unit are separate primary declarations and therefore normally reside in separate source files within the same package. They are shown together below only to illustrate their relationship.

```

// Vector.fol
Vector co.lang.struct = {
 x co.lang.float;
 y co.lang.float;
}

// Vector.unit.fol
_ co.lang.unit = {

 distance(
 left Vector,
 right Vector
)->(co.lang.float) = {
 ...
 }

 isZero(value Vector)->(co.lang.bool) = {
 this.return value.x == 0.0 && value.y == 0.0;
 }
}

```

Receiverless functions in a companion unit are accessed through the shared struct/unit name:

```

d := Vector.distance(first, second);
zero := Vector.isZero(value);

```

These functions are analogous to **static functions of a class** in call form, but FoLang additionally requires their **first declared parameter** to have the matching struct type. The first parameter establishes ownership by the companion unit. A matching struct type in a later parameter is insufficient.

```

Vector co.lang.unit = {
 distance(left Vector, right Vector)->(co.lang.float) = { ... } // ✓
 convert(value Vector, radix co.lang.int)->(co.lang.string) = { ... } // ✓

 invalid(scale co.lang.float, value Vector)->(Vector) = { ... }
 // ✗ first parameter is not Vector

```

```
zero()->(Vector) = { ... }
// ❌ no first parameter identifies Vector ownership
}
```

Therefore, factory-style functions such as `Vector.create(x, y)` and zero-parameter functions such as `Vector.zero()` are not valid members of a `Vector` companion unit under this rule. They may be placed in a standalone unit with a different name when needed.

Companion-unit functions do not make the struct a class and do not introduce object identity, inheritance, virtual dispatch, lifecycle methods, or unit-level state.

## Associated Functions in a Companion Unit

A companion unit may also contain associated functions whose explicit receiver has the matching struct type:

```
Vector co.lang.unit = {
 (value Vector) magnitude()->(co.lang.float) = {
 this.return co.math.sqrt(
 value.x * value.x + value.y * value.y
);
 }

 (value Vector) scale(factor co.lang.float)->(Vector) = {
 this.return Vector{
 x: value.x * factor,
 y: value.y * factor
 };
 }
}
```

Associated functions may be invoked using method-call syntax:

```
length := v.magnitude();
scaled := v.scale(2.0);
```

The method-call form is syntactic association. Conceptually:

```
v.magnitude()
```

resolves to the associated function declared in `Vector co.lang.unit` with `v` supplied as its explicit receiver. Associated functions are therefore analogous to **instance methods**, but they remain externally declared functions and do not acquire class semantics.

Associated-function rules for struct companion units:

- the explicit receiver type must be the struct whose name matches the unit name
- the receiver itself establishes the association; the ordinary parameter list does not need to contain the matching struct type
- the first-parameter ownership rule for receiverless companion functions does not apply to associated functions
- the matching struct and unit must be declared in the same package
- a struct-associated function cannot be declared loose at package scope
- associated functions have no inheritance, overriding, or virtual dispatch
- associated functions receive no special private access beyond the normal visibility rules
- an imported struct with the same short name does not create a companion relationship

```
Employee co.lang.struct = {
 id co.lang.int;
}

Employee co.lang.unit = {
 (emp Employee) isValid()->(co.lang.bool) = { ... } // ✓
 (dept Department) isValid()->(co.lang.bool) = { ... } // ✗ receiver does not match Employee
}
```

## Companion Name Rules

Within one package, FoLang may contain:

```
one Vector co.lang.struct
one Vector co.lang.unit
```

Together they form one struct/companion pair. The following are compiler errors:

```
two units named Vector in the same package
a unit matching a class or cstruct
a companion unit located in a different package from its struct
a receiverless companion function with no parameters or whose first parameter is not the matching struct
a companion associated function whose explicit receiver is not the matching struct
```

Name resolution is determined by context:

```
v Vector; // type position → Vector struct
v := Vector{x: 1, y: 2}; // construction → Vector struct
z := Vector.isZero(v); // qualified function lookup → Vector companion unit
m := v.magnitude(); // associated-function lookup → Vector companion unit
```

```
x General = General{}; // ✗ compiler error – a unit is not instantiable
```

## Functions

**Package-file rule:** A free function cannot be a primary top-level declaration in an ordinary package source file. It must appear inside a `co.lang.unit`, `co.lang.module`, or another declaration kind that permits functions. Standalone function snippets in this section demonstrate function syntax and are not complete package files unless an enclosing declaration is shown.

### Normal

```
General co.lang.unit = {
 fun1(k co.lang.int, b co.lang.char)->(co.lang.int, co.lang.char) = {
 // function body
 }
}
```

## Local Type Declarations

Functions can declare types locally. Local types are scoped to the function body only — they cannot appear in the function's parameter or return types, and are not accessible outside.

```
processEmployee()->(co.lang.bool) = {
 // Local ADT – scoped to this function only
 Status co.lang.type = Active | Inactive | Pending;

 // Local struct – scoped to this function only
 LocalRecord co.lang.struct = {
 id co.lang.int;
 status Status;
 }

 r := LocalRecord{ id: 1, status: Active };
 this.return r.status == Active;
}
```

```
// ❌ Compiler error – local type cannot appear in return type
getRecord()->(LocalRecord) = {
 LocalRecord co.lang.struct = { id co.lang.int; }
 this.return LocalRecord{ id: 1 };
}
```

Local types can be passed to inner functions defined within the same scope:

```
process()->(co.lang.int) = {
 Status co.lang.type = Active | Inactive;

 // Inner function – can use Status because it shares the same scope
 check(s Status)->(co.lang.bool) = {
 this.return s == Active;
 }

 this.return check(Active).return(1).otherwise.return(0);
}
```

## Curried

```
add(first co.lang.int)(second co.lang.int)->(co.lang.int)={
 this.return first + second
}
```

## Closure

```
adder() -> ((co.lang.int) -> co.lang.int) = {
 sum co.lang.int = 0
 this.return (x co.lang.int) -> (co.lang.int) = {
 sum += x
 this.return sum
 }
}
```

## Functions Taking and Returning Functions

### Syntax 1 — Inline signature

```
someFunction (r (co.lang.int, co.lang.int)->(co.lang.int))->((co.lang.int)->(co.lang.int))={}
```

### Syntax 2 — Named type alias

```
someFArg co.lang.type = (co.lang.int, co.lang.int)->(co.lang.int)
someFRet co.lang.type = (co.lang.int)->(co.lang.int)

someFunction (r someFArg)->(someFRet)={}
```

### Syntax 3 — Function objects

```
someFArg co.lang.function = (a co.lang.int, b co.lang.int) -> (co.lang.int)={
 this.return a + b;
}

someFRet co.lang.function = (a co.lang.int) -> (co.lang.int)={
 this.return a * 2;
}
```

## Anonymous Functions and Objects

### Anonymous Classes/Types

```
emp := co.lang.class{};

empObj := emp.new();

empobj1 := co.lang.class{
 name string
}.new();
```

### Anonymous Functions

```
add := (a int, b int) -> (int) {
 this.return a + b;
};

res := (a int, b int) -> (int) {
 this.return a * b;
})(10, 20);
```

## Lambda

Only allowed as an inline callback argument to collection operations (e.g. `map`, `filter`, `reduce`, `forEach`, `sortBy`, `groupBy`). Using `|...|` anywhere else is a syntax/lint error.

```
// Syntax
|x, y| => x + y;

// Collection use – allowed
nums.map(|x| => x*x)
words.filter(|s| => s.len() > 3)
pairs.reduce(|acc, e| => acc + e, 0)
dict.map(|k, v| => v * 10)
list.sortBy(|a, b| => a.score - b.score)
```

## Inner Function

```
myfun(a co.lang.int, b co.lang.int)->(co.lang.int)={
 p co.lang.int = 10;
 someother()->()={
 co.out.println(p);
 }
 someother();
 p = 20;
 someother();
}
```

## Other ways to declare closures/function objects and types/ curried functions

```
myobj co.lang.function = (a co.lang.int, b co.lang.int)->(co.lang.int)={
 this.return a + b;
}

add (a co.lang.int, b co.lang.int)->(co.lang.int){ this.return a + b; }
oObj co.lang.function = add;

funtype co.lang.type = (a co.lang.int, b co.lang.int)->(co.lang.int);

closure(factor int) => (x int) = x * factor;

curry(factor int)(val int) = factory * val;
```

## Default Parameters

```
fun1 (k co.lang.int, b co.lang.char = 10)->(co.lang.int, co.lang.char)={
}
```

## Variadic Functions

Curried functions are not allowed to be variadic, and vice versa.

```
fun1 (k co.lang.int, ...b co.lang.char)->(co.lang.int, co.lang.char)={
}
```

## Optional Parameters

```
fun1(k? co.lang.int)->()={
 if k.omitted{

 }else{

 }
}
```

## Named Parameters

```
fun1(~k co.lang.int)->()={
}
```

## Named Returns

```
doManythings(a co.lang.int, b co.lang.int->(&, meta={type=out}))->(r co.lang.int, e
co.lang.exception)={}
```

## Function Delegates

```
@co.dap.delegate someDelegate co.lang.delegate = (a co.lang.int, b co.lang.int) -> (co.lang.int,
co.lang.int);
```

## Function Chaining

```
fetchEmployee(empId co.lang.string)->(Employee)=>>empMod.getEmployee(this, empId);
```

## Associated Functions

For a user-defined struct, associated functions must be declared inside the same-package companion unit whose name matches the struct.

```

Employee co.lang.struct = {
 id co.lang.int;
 name co.lang.string;
}

Employee co.lang.unit = {

 compare(
 left Employee,
 right Employee
)->(co.lang.int) = {
 ...
 }

 (emp Employee) fetchEmployee(empId co.lang.string)->(Employee) = {
 ...
 }
}

```

Call forms:

```

order := Employee.compare(emp, other); // receiverless function – static-like call form
result := emp.fetchEmployee("E1"); // associated function – instance-method-like

```

For the receiverless companion function, the first ordinary parameter must be `Employee`; a later `Employee` parameter would not establish ownership. For the associated function, `(emp Employee)` is the explicit receiver and already establishes the association, so no ordinary parameter is required to have type `Employee`.

The associated receiver remains explicit in the declaration even though method-call syntax is available at the call site. This does not give the struct class semantics: there is no inheritance, overriding, virtual dispatch, hidden receiver, or lifecycle.

## Scoping Rules for Functions

All functions in FoLang have a defined scope — the set of variables a function can access.

---

### Default — Lexical / Static Scope

All of the following are **always** lexically scoped — this cannot be changed:

```

methods
inner methods
free functions
inner functions
closures
lambdas
Generic Functions
Anonymous functions
Curried functions

```

Lexical scope means a function resolves names from its **declaration site**, not from the scope of its caller. Unit-level variables are forbidden, so a unit-scoped free function receives runtime values through parameters or introduces them locally. Inner functions may capture variables from the enclosing function scope.



```
ScopeExample co.lang.unit = {
 foo()->() = {
 x co.lang.int = 10;

 printX()->() = {
 co.out.println(x); // ✅ x from the enclosing lexical scope
 }

 printX();
 }
}
```

### Associated Functions — Additional Scope Options

Only associated functions support non-lexical scoping via annotations:

The examples below are members of the same-package `Employee` companion unit.

`@co.dap.lexicalscope` — default, explicit declaration

```
Employee co.lang.unit = {
 @co.dap.lexicalscope
 (emp Employee) process()->() = {
 co.out.println(emp.name); // ✅ declaration scope
 }
}
```

`@co.dap.dynamicscope` — accesses caller's scope

```
Employee co.lang.unit = {
 @co.dap.dynamicscope
 (emp Employee) process()->() = {
 co.out.println(name); // name comes from caller's scope
 }
}
```

`@co.dap.mixedscope` — accesses both scopes

```
Employee co.lang.unit = {
 // caller scope takes priority – shadows declaration scope on conflict
 @co.dap.mixedscope
 (emp Employee) process()->() = {
 co.out.println(name); // caller scope takes priority
 co.out.println(emp.id); // falls back to declaration scope
 }
}
```

### Lambda Scope Inside Dynamically Scoped Methods

A lambda is always lexically scoped — this never changes. However when a lambda is passed to a dynamically scoped associated method such as `reduce`, `map`, `filter`, or `each`, it executes within that method's dynamic scope context. The caller's variables

become accessible through the method's scope, not through the lambda itself.

```
nums.reduce(|acc, e| => {
 total += e // accessible via reduce's dynamic scope – not the lambda's own scope
 acc + e
}, 0)
```

The lambda did not change. `reduce` is a dynamically scoped associated method — it carries the caller's scope and the lambda executes inside it.

### Why Dynamic Scope Exists — `.do` `.loop` `.each` and Collections

The entire FoLang control flow model is built on dynamically scoped associated functions. Without dynamic scope these constructs cannot read or modify the caller's variables — making them useless:

```
x co.lang.int = 10;
total co.lang.int = 0;
arr co.lang.int->([5]) = [1, 2, 3, 4, 5];

// .do – dynamic scope – reads and modifies caller's x
(x > 5).do({
 x.value = 20 // ✅ modifies caller's x
 co.out.println(x) // ✅ reads caller's x
})

// .loop – dynamic scope – modifies caller's x
(x > 0).loop({
 x.value-- // ✅ caller's x
})

// .each – dynamic scope – modifies caller's total
arr.each(_, val).do({
 total.value += val // ✅ caller's total
})

// .filter .map .reduce – dynamic scope
nums.filter(|x| => x > 10)
nums.reduce(|acc, e| => {
 total.value += e // ✅ caller's total
 acc + e
}, 0)
```

If `.do` were lexically scoped:

```
do's declaration site has no x
x would be invisible ❌
cannot read caller's x ❌
cannot modify caller's x ❌
control flow becomes useless ❌
```

### FoLang Control Flow Is Dynamic Scope

```

no if/else keywords → .do / .otherwise – dynamic scope
no for/while keywords → .loop – dynamic scope
no foreach keywords → .each – dynamic scope
no in keywords → .contains – dynamic scope
no map/filter keywords → .map / .filter – dynamic scope

```

```

all control flow implemented as associated functions
all dynamically scoped
caller variables fully accessible and modifiable
no special language constructs needed
scope model directly enables control flow model

```

### Conflict Resolution in Dynamic and/or Mixed Scope

```

same variable name exists in both scopes:
 Local scope → wins – shadows Caller scope
 caller scope → wins – shadows declaration scope
 declaration scope → masked for that variable

```

### Additional Rules for non lexical scopes for associated functions

1. Non lexical scope functions cannot be passed or returned

### Scope Rules Summary

Function Type	Lexical	Dynamic	Mixed
methods	✓ only	✗	✗
inner methods	✓ only	✗	✗
free functions	✓ only	✗	✗
inner functions	✓ only	✗	✗
anonymous functions	✓ only	✗	✗
closures	✓ only	✗	✗
lambdas	✓ only	✗	✗
associated functions	✓ default	✓ opt-in	✓ opt-in
.do / .loop / .each	✗	✓ built-in	✗
.map / .filter / .reduce	✗	✓ built-in	✗

### Indexer

Indexer functions for a struct are associated functions and must be declared inside the matching companion unit.

```

MyList co.lang.struct = {
 eles co.lang.int->([...]);
}

```

```

}

MyList co.lang.unit = {

 @co.dap.indexer(symbol="[]")
 (g MyList) get(index co.lang.int)->(co.lang.int) ={
 this.return g.eles[index]
 }

 @co.dap.indexer(symbol="[]=")
 (g MyList) set(index co.lang.int, value co.lang.int)->() ={
 g.eles[index] = value
 }
}

lst MyList;
co.out.println(lst[0]);
lst[1] = 22;

```

## Inline

```

Math co.lang.unit = {
 @co.dap.inline
 add(a co.lang.int, b co.lang.int)->(co.lang.int) ={
 this.return a + b;
 }
}

```

## Lazy

```

@co.dap.lazy
x = add(1, 2); //on doing some thing on x calls add(1,2) till that time add function on right hand
side is not invoked

```

## Native Functions

```

@co.dap.native
nativeMethod(a co.lang.int, b co.lang.int)->(co.lang.int) ={
 // native implementation
}

```

## Generics

```

@co.dap.generic(
 at=runtime,
 type={
 T: {variance:invariant, bound=Number, kind:param, impredicative:false},
 R: {variance:invariant, bound=Number, kind:return}
 }
)
add(a T, b T)->(R) = { this.return a + b; }

```

**Generic annotation fields:**

- `at` — `runtime` | `compiletime` (acts like C++ templates)
- `refied` — `true` | `false`
- `where` — `usesite` | `callsite`

**typename/type attributes:**

Attribute	Values
variance	<code>covariant</code> , <code>invariant</code> , <code>contravariant</code>
bound	type to bind
kind	<code>param</code> , <code>result</code> , <code>var</code> , <code>arg</code>
default	default type
nullable	bool
inclusive	bool
impredicative	bool — when <code>true</code> , allows <code>T</code> to be instantiated with a <code>forall</code> type (v2)
typekind	<code>type</code> , <code>class</code> , <code>function</code> , <code>module</code> , <code>unit</code> , <code>package</code>
types	list of allowed types for constraints

## Generic Functions — Parameters and Return Values

**Rank-1: Outer function is generic; parameter uses the same type variable**

`T` is fixed at the call site before the function parameter is used. The passed function is already monomorphic inside the body.

**Syntax 1 — Inline signature**

```
@co.dap.generic(type={T:{variance:invariant}})
someFunction(f (T, T)->(T), a T)->(T) = {}
```

**Syntax 2 — Named type alias**

```
@co.dap.generic(type={T:{variance:invariant}})
someFArg co.lang.type = (T, T)->(T)

someFunction(f someFArg, a T, b T)->(T) = {}
```

**Rank-2: The function parameter is itself polymorphic (higher-rank)**

The passed function stays generic **inside the callee**. The callee decides what `T` is. Uses existing `forall`.

**Syntax 1 — Inline signature**

```
someFunction(f forall(T).(T, T)->(T))->(co.lang.int) = {
 this.return f(1, 2);
}
```

**Syntax 2 — Named type alias**

```
someFArg co.lang.type = forall(T).(T, T)->(T)

someFunction(f someFArg)->(co.lang.int) = {}
```

```
// Correct – Syntax 2 with co.lang.type
someFArg co.lang.type = forall(T).(T, T)->(T)

someFunction(f someFArg)->(co.lang.int) = {}
```

## Returning Generic Functions

### Rank-1 return

```
@co.dap.generic(type={T:{variance:invariant}})
makeAdder(a T)->((T)->(T)) = {
 this.return (b T)->(T) = { this.return a + b; };
}
```

### Rank-2 return — returning a polymorphic function

```
makeIdentity()->(forall(T).(T)->(T)) = {
 this.return forall(T).(x T)->(T) = { this.return x; };
}
```

## Rank-3: A Parameter is Itself a Rank-2 Function

Rank-3 works naturally in FoLang via `forall` nesting. No new constructs needed.

### Syntax 1 — Inline

```
// f takes a Rank-2 function as its argument – that is Rank-3
applyRank2(
 f (forall(T).(T, T)->(T)) -> (co.lang.int)
) -> (co.lang.int) = {
 this.return f(1, 1);
}
```

### Syntax 2 — Named type aliases (cleaner)

```
rank2FnType co.lang.type = forall(T).(T, T)->(T)
rank3ArgType co.lang.type = (rank2FnType) -> (co.lang.int)

applyRank2(f rank3ArgType) -> (co.lang.int) = {
 this.return f(1, 1);
}
```

### Rank-3 return

```
makeRank2Consumer() -> ((forall(T).(T)->(T)) -> (co.lang.int)) = {
 this.return (f forall(T).(T)->(T)) -> (co.lang.int) = {
 this.return f(42);
 };
}
```

Impredicativity — Instantiating **T** with a **forall** Type

Impredicativity is when a type variable **T** in a generic is itself instantiated with a **forall** type. Example of what this means:

```
@co.dap.generic(type={T:{variance:invariant}})
box(x T) -> (Box(T)) = {}

// Impredicative call – T being set to forall(U).(U)->(U)
result := box(forall(U).(U)->(U)); // ❌ not legal without explicit opt-in
```

Most type systems reject this by default. FoLang takes an opt-in approach.

v1 Workaround — Option C: Wrapping with **co.lang.type**

Not true impredicativity but solves 90% of practical cases:

```
polyId co.lang.type = forall(U).(U)->(U)

// box takes co.lang.type – no impredicative unification needed
box(x co.lang.type) -> (Box(co.lang.type)) = {}

result := box(polyId); // ✅ works – x is co.lang.type, not a forall type
```

v2 — Option A: **impredicative:true** in **@co.dap.generic**

Explicit opt-in via the existing annotation. The compiler only permits **forall** instantiation where declared:

```
@co.dap.generic(
 type={T:{variance:invariant, impredicative:true}}
)
box(x T) -> (Box(T)) = {}

polyId co.lang.type = forall(U).(U)->(U)
result := box(polyId); // ✅ legal – impredicative:true explicitly opts in
```

Generic Function Rank Support Matrix

Scenario	Allow?	Notes
Rank-1 generic param (Syntax 1, 2, 3)	✅ Yes	Natural extension, no new concepts
Rank-1 generic return (Syntax 1, 2, 3)	✅ Yes	Same as above
Rank-2 param via <b>forall</b> (Syntax 1, 2)	✅ Yes	<b>co.lang.type</b> naturally holds polymorphic types; no new kind needed

Scenario	Allow?	Notes
Rank-2 param via Syntax 3 <code>co.lang.function</code>	✗ Compiler error	Function objects are concrete values; use <code>co.lang.type = forall(T).(T)-&gt;(T)</code> instead
Rank-2 return via <code>forall</code> (Syntax 1, 2)	✓ Yes	Same reasoning as param
Rank-3 via <code>forall</code> nesting (Syntax 1, 2)	✓ Yes	No new constructs — <code>forall</code> nesting works naturally
Rank-3 return	✓ Yes	Same reasoning as Rank-3 param
Rank-3 via Syntax 3 <code>co.lang.function</code>	✗ Compiler error	Same rule as Rank-2; function objects are concrete
Impredicative — v1 workaround (Option C)	✓ Yes	Wrap <code>forall</code> type in <code>co.lang.type</code> ; solves 90% of real cases
Impredicative — true opt-in (Option A)	➡ SOON v2	<code>impredicative:true</code> in <code>@co.dap.generic</code> ; explicit opt-in

## Generic Types

```

@co.dap.generic(tyname=T)
LinkedList co.lang.struct={
 value T
 next LinkedList
 prev LinkedList
}

k := LinkedList.@@new(co.lang.int);

@co.dap.generic(type={T:{tyname}}, R:{tyname}})
Employee co.lang.class = {
 id T
 name R

 @co.dap.override
 @co.dap.constructor(access=private)
 @@init() = {}

 @co.dap.override
 @co.dap.constructor(access=public)
 @@init(id T, name R) = {
 this.parent.@@init();
 this.id = id;
 this.name = name;
 }

 getEmployee(id T)->(Employee)={}
}

a := Employee.@@new(co.lang.int, co.lang.string);
b := a.@@init(1, "Rao");

Normally we need not use @@new and @@init it is special case only applicable for Generics

```

## Generics Inheritances and Types



This is in conceptual stage not supported.

- A) Abstract vs concrete type members
- B) Path-dependent types
  1. Type-level projection
  2. Path-dependent In folang how it would be

## forall

### What forall Is — and Is Not

`forall` is **not** a general-purpose generic declaration keyword. It is a **type-level expression only**, restricted to contexts where a polymorphic type must appear as an anonymous value inline — specifically Rank-2 and Rank-3 parameter and return positions, and `co.lang.type` aliases.

`@co.dap.generic` is the **one and only** way to declare generic functions, structs, classes, and other named things. `forall` at declaration level is a **compiler error**.

### Where forall Is Allowed — Type Expression Form Only

`forall(T).` followed by an anonymous type body. The `.` is the syntactic signal that what follows is a type body, not a declaration name.

Pattern:

```
forall(T). <anonymous type body>
```

```
// co.lang.type alias – naming a polymorphic type for reuse
someFArg co.lang.type = forall(T).(T, T)->(T)

// Rank-2 inline parameter – callee decides what T is
someFunction(f forall(T).(T)->(T)) -> (co.lang.int) = {}

// Rank-2 return type – returning a polymorphic function
makeIdentity() -> (forall(T).(T)->(T)) = {}

// Rank-3 inline parameter – f takes a Rank-2 function
applyRank2(f (forall(T).(T, T)->(T)) -> (co.lang.int)) -> (co.lang.int) = {}
```

### Where forall Is Banned — Use @co.dap.generic Instead

```
// ❌ compiler error – forall at declaration level
forall(T) identity(x T)->(T) = {}

// ✅ correct
@co.dap.generic(type={T:{variance:invariant}})
identity(x T)->(T) = {}
```

```
// ❌ compiler error
forall(T) LinkedList co.lang.struct = { value T; next LinkedList; }
```

```
// ✅ correct
@co.dap.generic(typename=T)
LinkedList co.lang.struct = { value T; next LinkedList; }
```

```
// ❌ compiler error – Rank-1 generics belong to @co.dap.generic
forall(T) someFunction(f (T,T)->(T), a T)->(T) = {}

// ✅ correct
@co.dap.generic(type={T:{variance:invariant}})
someFunction(f (T,T)->(T), a T)->(T) = {}
```

Quick Reference

Form	Status	Context
<code>forall(T) name ...</code>	❌ Compiler error	Declaration level — use <code>@co.dap.generic</code> instead
<code>forall(T).(T)-&gt;(T)</code>	✅ Allowed	Type level only — Rank-2/3 param, return, <code>co.lang.type</code> alias

The rule in one sentence: `forall(T).` is a type constructor for anonymous polymorphic types; it is never a declaration keyword.

Templates

Typed

```
@co.dap.template
add(a co.lang.int, b co.lang.int)->(co.lang.int) ={
 this.return a + b;
}
```

Untyped

```
@co.dap.template
add(a, b)->(co.lang.untyped) ={
 this.return a + b;
}
```

Macros

```
// a. Basic macro
@co.dap.macro
say()->()={ this.return co.macro.quote({ println("Line 1") println("Line 2") }); }

// b. Escape assign
@co.dap.macro
yes_esc_assign()->(co.lang.untyped)={
 this.return co.macro.quote({
 co.macro.esc(y) = 42
 println("Inside macro: y = ", y)
 });
}
```

```

}

// c. Debug macro with gensym
@co.dap.macro
debug(expr)->(co.lang.untyped)={
 let tmp = co.macro.gensym(co.lang.var, "tmp")
 this.return co.macro.quote({
 tmp = co.macro.esc(expr)
 println("Result: ", tmp)
 tmp
 });
}

// d. if/else condition macro
@co.dap.macro(
 group = {items:["if","else"], chain:true},
 sugarform={forms:["if expr block"]},
 bind={vars:["x"]},
 isolate={vars:["temp", "index"]},
 gensym={prefix:"tmp_"},
 hygienic=true,
 argtransform={param:"body", wrap:"lambda", whentype:"block"},
 desugar={exprs:["if($cond) { $block }" => "if($cond,$block)"]},
 mode="inject"
)
if(condition expr, body block)->()={}

blockormacro co.lang.Kind = block | macro

@co.dap.macro(
 group={items:["if","else"], chain:true},
 sugarform={forms:["else block","else if"]},
 chainswith={macro:"if", position:"immediate", required:true},
 argtransform={param:"body", wrap:"lambda", whentype:"block"},
 standalone=false,
 desugar={exprs:[
 "else if($cond) { $block }" => "else(if($cond, $block))",
 "else { $elseblock }" => "else($elseblock)"
]},
)
else(body blockormacro)->()={}

```

Other macro utilities:

1. `@co.dap.compose(using=["base_if", "blockify"])`
2. `@co.dap.guard(expr="is_bool_expr(expr)")`
3. Quasiquote macros use `co.macro.quote` and `co.macro.unquote`

## Annotations and Decorators

```

// Annotation – static object, can carry data

myAnnotation co.lang.object->(for=annotation) = {
 value co.lang.string;
 enabled co.lang.bool;
}

// Decorator – function, transforms target, returns
@co.dap.decorator

```

```
myDecorator(target co.lang.function)->(co.lang.function) = { }
```

Note Directives and Pragmas are not allowed to create as they are language internals

## Pattern Matching

```
x co.lang.int = 10;

x.match.case(n: n > 10 => { n = n+100; "GT" }).case(n: n < 10 => "LT").default("EQ");
x.match.case(n: n > 10 => { n = n+100; "GT" }).case(n: n < 10 => "LT").case(_=>"EQ");
x.match(co.pattern.Type).case(co.lang.int => ...).case(co.lang.float => ...);
x.match(co.pattern.Value).case(0 => ...).case(1 => ...);
x.match(co.pattern.Instance).case(xx.CAT => ...).case(xx.DOG => ...).default("Animal");
x.match(co.pattern.Object).case(xx.Ball => "Ball").case(xx.CAT => "CAT").default("Unknown");
x.match(co.pattern.Shape).case(Point{x, y} => ...).default(...);

x.match(co.pattern.Any).case(co.lang.int => ...).case(co.lang.float => ...).case(0 => ...).default(
...);

x.match(PositiveEvenMatcher).case(0 => "Neither even nor odd").case(2 => "First Even
Prime").default(...);
```

**Object vs Instance in FoLang:** Instance is from types of class/structs. Objects are anything — functions, classes, structs, types, etc.

`_` is a special discard/wildcard variable usable only inside pattern matching, contains, and iterator constructs. Elsewhere `_` must be accompanied by an ASCII letter or number.

## Custom Matcher

```
@co.dap.matcher
Matcher(T) = {
 matchCase(value T, pattern co.lang.untyped) -> (co.lang.int, co.lang.MatchBindings);
 // int return: 0 = no match, >0 = match
}

PositiveEvenMatcher co.lang.Matcher->(for=Matcher, type=co.lang.int) = {
 matchCase(value co.lang.int, pat co.lang.untyped)->(co.lang.int, co.lang.MatchBindings) = {
 // user logic
 }
}
```

## Monads, Applicatives, Functors, Monoids and Transformers

`@co.dap.typeclass(kind=...)` is the single annotation for all typeclass definitions. `kind` specifies the algebraic structure — `Functor`, `Applicative`, `Monad`, `Monoid`, `Transformer`, or any user-defined kind. Instances of any typeclass always use `co.lang.instance`.

## Functor

```
@co.dap.typeclass(kind=Functor)
Functor(F) = {
 map(value F(A), f (A)->B) -> (F(B));
```

```

}

ListFuncor co.lang.instance->(for=Funcor, type=List) = {
 map(value List(A), f (A)->(B))->(List(B)) = {
 result = List(B){}
 value.each(_, item).do({ result.append(f(item)) });
 this.return result
 }
}

```

## Applicative

```

@co.dap.typeclass(kind=Applicative)
Applicative(F) = {
 pure(x A) -> (F(A));
 apply(fab F(A->B), fa F(A)) -> (F(B));
}

OptionApplicative co.lang.instance->(for=Applicative, type=Option) = {
 pure(x A)->(Option(A)) = { this.return Some(x); }
 apply(fab Option(A->B), fa Option(A))->(Option(B)) = {
 this.return (fab, fa)
 .match
 .case((Some(f), Some(x)) => Some(f(x)))
 .default(None());
 }
}

```

## Monad

```

@co.dap.typeclass(kind=Monad)
Monad(F) = {
 pure(x A) -> (F(A));
 flatMap(fa F(A), f (A)->F(B)) -> (F(B));
}

OptionMonad co.lang.instance->(for=Monad, type=Option) = {
 pure(x A)->(Option(A)) = { this.return Some(x); }
 flatMap(fa Option(A), f (A)->Option(B))->(Option(B)) = {
 this.return fa.match().case(Some(x) => f(x)).default(None);
 }
}

```

## Monoid

```

@co.dap.typeclass(kind=Monoid)
Monoid(T) = {
 empty() -> (T);
 combine(a T, b T) -> (T);
}

IntMonoid co.lang.instance->(for=Monoid, type=co.lang.int) = {
 empty()->(co.lang.int) = { this.return 0; }
 combine(a co.lang.int, b co.lang.int)->(co.lang.int) = { this.return a + b; }
}

```

## Transformer

```
@co.dap.typeclass(kind=Transformer)
Transformer(F(_), G(_)) = {
 map(value F(A), f (A)->B) -> (G(B));
}

ListToSetTransformer co.lang.instance->(for=Transformer, types=[List, Set]) = {
 map(value List(A), f (A)->B)->(Set(B)) = {
 result = Set(B){}
 value.each(_, item).do({ result.insert(f(item)) });
 this.return result;
 }
}
```

## Let Bindings

```
y co.lang.int = let({x = 10}).in({x + 1});
y co.lang.int = let({$ = 10}).in({$ + 1}); // $ refers to the value being defined

x co.lang.int = (x + 1).where(x = 10);
x co.lang.int = ($ + 1).where($ = 10);

offset := 100;

let adjust(0) = offset
let adjust(n) = n + offset
```

`$` is a special identifier usable in ordinary `let` binding expressions for recursive or self-referential expressions.

Ordinary `let` value-binding expressions remain available in language contexts that permit them, but they are forbidden directly in the application entry file. In the entry file, `let` is reserved exclusively for a named function-pattern group that captures at least one surrounding runtime binding. It cannot introduce an anonymous function, a general closure value, or a curried function.

## Function Pattern

```
f(Some(x)) => { x + 1 }
f(None()) => { 0 }

// desugars to:
f(v) =>{
 v.match().case(x: Some(x) => x + 1).case(_: None() => 0);
}
```

Function-pattern groups are permitted in the application entry file as restricted entry-local dispatch helpers. A bare group cannot capture surrounding runtime variables. A `let` function-pattern group must capture at least one already initialized entry-file runtime binding and is the only entry-file construct that permits such capture. Neither form permits ordinary function declarations, anonymous functions, general closure values, currying, partial application, or escape as a function value.

## Conditions, Loops and Iterators

### Conditions

```
(boolean truth).do({
}).otherwise(boolean truth).do({
}).otherwise.do({
});
```

## Loops

```
(boolean truth).loop({
}).otherwise(boolean truth).loop({
}).otherwise.loop({
});
```

## Condition and Loop Mix

```
(boolean truth).do({
}).otherwise(boolean truth).loop({
}).otherwise(boolean truth).do({
}).otherwise.loop({
});
```

## Ternary Operator

```
s = (boolean truth).return(some var/value).otherwise.return(some val/var);
s = (boolean truth).return(some var/val).otherwise(boolean truth).return(some
var/val).otherwise.return(some var/val);
```

## Looping Arrays / Lists / Maps / Ranges

```
arr co.lang.int->([5]) = [6,7,8,9,10];
arr.each(idx, val).do({
 co.out.print(idx);
 co.out.print(" :: ");
 co.out.println(val);
});

arr.each(_, val).do({
 co.out.println(val);
});
```

## Array / List / Map / Range — Contains Element

```
arr co.lang.int->([5]) = [35,57,96,81,31];
k co.lang.int = 31;
arr.contains(k).do({
 co.out.println(k);
}).otherwise.do({
 co.out.println("Not Found");
});
```

## Comprehensions (*planned*)

```
k := (1..10).filter(|x| => x % 2 == 0).map(|x| => x * x);

result := for (x <- List(1,2,3)).yield(x * 2) // List(2, 4, 6)
result := for (x <- Set(1,2,3)).yield(x * 2) // Set(2, 4, 6)
result := for (x <- Some(5)).yield(x * 2) // Some(10)
result := for (x <- fetchData()).yield(x.process()) // Future

ages := {"A":30,"B":40,"C":66,"e":88};
upper := for ((name, age) <- ages).yield(name.toUpperCase, age)
```

## Extensions

```
stringextension co.lang.unit={

 @co.dap.extension(fortype=co.lang.string, what=extends)
 upperCase()->(string)={
 return this.upper()
 }

 @co.dap.extension(fortype=[co.lang.string], what=overrides)
 equals(str string)->(bool)={
 this.return this == str
 }
}
```

Extensions must be **explicitly activated** — they are block-scoped:

```
@co.ddap.use(from="stringextension",extensions=[equals, upperCase])
k.upperCase(); //  explicitly activated
```

## Labels and Named Blocks

```
// Label
outer:{
 // statements
}

// Named Block
labelBlock co.lang.block={

}

labelBlock.expand();
```

## Reflection

```
@co.dap.reflection(enable=True, package="co.meta")
```



```
x co.lang.int = 10;
x.reflect().getType() → co.lang.int
x.reflect().getValue() → 10
x.reflect().getKind() → value
```

## Forward / Extern Declarations

### Variable

```
@co.dap.extern
someBool co.lang.bool;
```

### Functions

```
@co.dap.extern
getEmployee(id co.lang.int)->(somepack.Employee);

// or — @co.dap.extern is optional for functions
getEmployee(id co.lang.int)->(somepack.Employee);
```

### Types

```
@co.dap.extern
Employee co.lang.struct;

// or — @co.dap.extern is optional for types
Employee co.lang.struct;
```

For functions and types `@co.dap.extern` is optional. For variables it is required.

## Interface vs Signature

```
MEmployee co.lang.signature = {
 Employee co.lang.struct;
 storeEmployee(emp Employee) -> (Employee);
}

IEmployee co.lang.interface = {
 storeEmployee(emp Employee) -> (Employee);
}
```

Structurally they look similar — both are lists of contracts. The difference is **who implements them and how**.

	<code>co.lang.signature</code>	<code>co.lang.interface</code>
Implemented by	module via <code>matches=</code>	class via <code>implements=[]</code>
Can include types/structs	✓	✗
Instantiation involved	✗	✓

	<code>co.lang.signature</code>	<code>co.lang.interface</code>
OOP dispatch	✗	✓ virtual/dynamic
Behavior only	✗	✓ (like Go)
Origin	ML/OCaml modules	Java/C#/Go interfaces

- A **signature** is a **structural contract** — can include types, structs, nested definitions. Describes a whole capability unit.
- An **interface** is a **behavioral contract** — methods only, no fields, no type declarations. Tied to OOP dispatch and polymorphism.

## Structs vs Classes vs Modules vs Units vs Packages

	<b>Struct</b>	<b>CStruct</b>	<b>Class</b>	<b>Module</b>	<b>Unit</b>	<b>Package</b>
<b>Purpose</b>	Pure data shape	C-like value type	Behaviour + data	Signature-backed ML-style abstraction	Named function container; optionally a struct companion	Folder-based grouping
<b>Fields</b>	✓	✓ simple only	✓ per instance	✗	✗	✗
<b>Functions / methods</b>	Optional static-like functions whose first parameter is the struct, plus receiver-based associated functions, through a matching companion unit	✗	✓ methods	✓ module functions	✓ receiverless functions; associated functions only when matching a struct	✗
<b>Lifecycle</b> ( <code>@@new/@@init</code> )	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗
<b>this / self</b>	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗
<b>Instantiable</b>	✗	✗	✓ multiple objects	✗	✗	✗
<b>First class</b>	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗
<b>Pass by</b>	Reference	Value	Reference	Reference	—	—
<b>Contract</b>	—	—	<code>interface</code> via <code>implements=[]</code>	<code>signature</code> via <code>matches=</code>	none	—
<b>OOP / inheritance</b>	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗
<b>Contains type declarations</b>	✓ struct/enum	✗	✓ inner, <code>Class.Type</code>	✓ through its module contract	✗	✓ across package files
<b>Pattern matching</b>	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗

	Struct	CStruct	Class	Module	Unit	Package
<b>Direct ABI / zone boundary safe</b>	✗ — library boundaries require snapshots	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
<b>Associated functions</b>	✓ through matching companion unit	✗	—	—	✓ only in a struct companion unit	✗
<b>Embedding</b>	✓	✗	—	—	✗	✗
<b>Declared with</b>	<code>co.lang.struct</code>	<code>co.lang.cstruct</code>	<code>co.lang.class</code>	<code>co.lang.module</code>	<code>co.lang.unit</code>	folder path
<b>C++ backend analogy</b>	struct without methods	plain C struct	class	struct/class abstraction	namespace or static function scope	namespace
<b>Closest mental model</b>	Rust struct	C struct	Java/C# class	OCaml module	named function scope; optional struct companion	filesystem namespace

#### Mental model:

```

reach for struct → pure data; use a same-name companion unit for behaviour
reach for cstruct → physical ABI-compatible value data crossing direct zone or native boundaries
reach for class → behaviour, lifecycle, multiple instances
reach for module → signature-backed abstraction that may own types
reach for unit → named function container; same-name struct unit acts as companion
reach for package → folder-based grouping only, not a value

```

**Type declaration scoping rule:** Modules own types as part of their public contract via signature. Classes own inner types accessible through `ClassName.TypeName`. Units do not own type declarations; they contain functions only. A same-name struct companion unit supplies static-like functions whose first parameter is the struct, receiver-based associated functions, and operator functions whose first operand is the struct, without changing the struct's pure-data semantics. Functions may declare types locally, but local types are scoped to the function body and cannot appear in the function's parameter or return types. Structs may contain nested data declarations only as permitted by the Struct Inner Type Rules; those nested types belong to the struct, not to its companion unit.

## Execution Models and Control Abstractions (library type=advanced)

FoLang executes code sequentially by default. It also provides a uniform execution model for concurrency, parallelism, asynchronous execution, coroutines, continuations, scheduling, and structured task execution.

Developers express the intended execution semantics by applying annotations such as `@co.dap.thread`, `@co.dap.task`, or `@co.dap.process` to a method. When the method is submitted through facilities such as `co.cpcp.submitToPool`, `co.cpcp.submitThread`, or `co.cpcp.submitToEventLoop`, the FoLang runtime selects and manages the appropriate execution mechanism.

Depending on the annotation, submission operation, runtime environment, and execution policy, FoLang may use a thread pool, virtual or green threads, an event loop, a dedicated operating-system thread, or a separate process. Communication operations such as sending and receiving values are also handled through the `co.cpcp` package. Developers therefore describe the required execution behavior without directly managing the underlying threads, processes, pools, or event loops.

The `@co.dap.continuation` annotation enables continuation support for a function. An annotated function can use constructs provided by the `co.cpa` package to suspend execution, yield control or a value, preserve its execution state, and later resume from the suspension point.

## Native Code (Library type system/ffi)

The `@co.dap.native` annotation enables access to the `co.native` package. Through this package, developers can write assembly and machine-level code using facilities such as `co.native.asm` and `co.native.inline`, providing low-level capabilities similar to those available in C++.

## Dynamic Runtime (library type=dynamicvmrt)

The `@co.ddap.dynamicruntime` annotation enables full access to the `co.meta` package. Through this package, developers can use dynamic class and type loading, monkey patching, runtime reflection, instrumentation, eval-based code execution, and other advanced metaprogramming capabilities.

## Package Aliasing

To alias/change the package name

1. Change folder name(s)
2. The needed subfolder of surface/entryfile folder must contain package.fol file

```
requiredname co.lang.package;
```

## Built-in Types

Type	Kind
co.lang.string	
co.lang.int	
co.lang.bit	
co.lang.double	
co.lang.float	
co.lang.long	
co.lang.byte	
co.lang.char	
co.lang.any	
co.lang.dynamic	
co.lang.auto	
co.lang.infer	
co.lang.bool	
co.lang.void	

Type	Kind
co.lang.data	
co.lang.value	
co.lang.typed	
co.lang.untyped	
co.mem.region	
co.lang.nothing	
co.lang.word	
co.lang.MatchBindings	
co.lang.tag	
co.lang.typevalue	
co.lang.uninit	
co.lang.Literal	

Built-in kinds

Kind	Purpose
co.lang.type	
co.lang.struct	
co.lang.cstruct	
co.lang.realm	similar to loader where symbols reside
co.lang.loader	class, type, functions loader where objects reside loader takes realm as parameter
co.lang.class	
co.lang.interface	
co.lang.union	
co.lang.role	
co.lang.record	
co.lang.property	
co.lang.indexer	
co.lang.object	
co.lang.instance	
co.lang.matcher	
co.lang.trait	
co.lang.mixin	
co.lang.extension	
co.lang.delegate	
co.lang.typeclass	

Kind	Purpose
<code>co.lang.concept</code>	
<code>co.lang.typealias</code>	
<code>co.lang.module</code>	
<code>co.lang.unit</code>	named, non-instantiable function container; same-name struct unit acts as companion
<code>co.lang.macro</code>	
<code>co.lang.template</code>	
<code>co.lang.lambda</code>	
<code>co.lang.block</code>	
<code>co.lang.behavior</code>	
<code>co.lang.package</code>	
<code>co.lang.signature</code>	
<code>co.lang.function</code>	
<code>co.lang.method</code>	
<code>co.lang.operator</code>	
<code>co.lang.namespace</code>	
<code>co.lang.stex</code>	
<code>co.lang.kind</code>	
<code>co.lang.level</code>	
<code>co.lang.order</code>	
<code>co.lang.rank</code>	
<code>co.lang.newtype</code>	
<code>co.lang.opaquetype</code>	
<code>co.lang.subtype</code>	
<code>co.lang.supertype</code>	
<code>co.lang.dependentType</code>	
<code>co.lang.refinementType</code>	
<code>co.lang.associatedtype</code>	
<code>co.lang.hkt</code>	higher kind type
<code>co.lang.hot</code>	higher order type
<code>co.lang.hrt</code>	higher rank type
<code>co.lang.data</code>	
<code>co.lang.enum</code>	
<code>co.lang.typetype</code>	
<code>co.lang.typekind</code>	
<code>co.lang.alias</code>	

Kind	Purpose
<code>co.lang.value</code>	
<code>co.lang.just</code>	
<code>co.lang.nothing</code>	

## Built-in Directives

Kind	
<b>PRAGMA</b>	"@co.pdap.compiler", "@co.pdap.scale"
<b>DIRECTIVE</b>	"@co.ddap.movetotop", "@co.ddap.import", "@co.ddap.dynamicruntime", "@co.ddap.use", @co.ddap.parent", "@co.ddap.alias"
<b>ANNOTATION</b>	"@co.dap.template", "@co.dap.macro", "@co.dap.operator", "@co.dap.annotation", "@co.dap.library", "@co.dap.module", "@co.dap.pragma", "@co.dap.directive", "@co.dap.native", "@co.dap.class", "@co.dap.static", "@co.dap.instance", "@co.dap.object", "@co.dap.inline", "@co.dap.ctfe", "@co.dap.friend", "@co.dap.sealed", "@co.dap.extension", "@co.dap.override", "@co.dap.virtual", "@co.dap.abstract", "@co.dap.delegate", "@co.dap.dynamicscope", "@co.dap.lexicalscope", "@co.dap.staticscope", "@co.dap.mixedscope", "@co.dap.typeclass", "@co.dap.matcher", "@co.dap.constructor", "@co.dap.oops", "@co.dap.hokrt", "@co.dap.hokrtl", "@co.dap.indexer", "@co.dap.generic", "@co.dap.comptime", "@co.dap.typefromvalue", "@co.dap.private", "@co.dap.public", "@co.dap.package", "@co.dap.protected", "@co.dap.internal", "@co.dap.export", "@co.dap.eager", "@co.dap.lazy", "@co.dap.packed", "@co.dap.declare", "@co.dap.simd", "@co.dap.reflection", "@co.dap.mop" <span>//mop =&gt; meta object programming</span>
<b>DECORATOR</b>	"@co.dap.before", "@co.dap.after", "@co.dap.around", "@co.fx.onErrExcept", "@co.fx.InvokeAlways", "@co.fx.HandleEffect", "@co.dap.callback", "@co.dap.defer", "@co.dap.continuation", "@co.dap.event", "@co.dap.scale", "@co.dap.distributed", "@co.dap.concurrent", "@co.dap.parallel", "@co.dap.subroutine", "@co.dap.generator", "@co.dap.goroutine", "@co.dap.coroutine", "@co.dap.async", "@co.dap.promise", "@co.dap.future", "@co.dap.thread", "@co.dap.task", "@co.dap.fiber", "@co.dap.process", "@co.dap.spawn", "@co.dap.exec", "@co.dap.fork", "@co.dap.csp", "@co.dap.actor", "@co.dap.synthetic", "@co.dap.bridge", "@co.dap.greenlet", "@co.dap.channel", "@co.dap.callable", "@co.dap.iterator"

## Built-in Packages

**co** — root (reserved word)

The only package provided by default.

Sub-package	Responsibility
<code>co.lang</code>	All data types and kinds
<code>co.sys</code>	file, concurrent, parallel, goto, invoke, bind, call, apply, setTimeout, setInterval, scheduler, cron, event
<code>co.os</code>	signal, cmd, execute, run, env, getenv, setenv, sleep, exit, cwd, chdir, fork, wait, pipe, dup, dup2, close, readfd, writefd, random
<code>co.meta</code>	ast, instrument, transform, augment, reflect, introspect, patch, inject, create, runtime(eval, proto, prototype, etc), realm
<code>co.core</code>	list, set, map, tree, trie, sort, search, array, pointer, ref, address, ptr, matrix, word

Sub-package	Responsibility
co.native	load, register, asm, inline, emit, ffi, spawnon[gpu,cpu,npu,apu,fpga,asic,tpu,mki,mcu],arch[x86,x86-64,risc,arm,vliw]
co.in	read, readln
co.out	println, print
co.regex	stex, pattern, match, search
co.crypto	rsa, aes, hash, md5, rand, uuid, ssl, tls
co.dap	built-in decorators, annotations
co.ddap	built-in directives
co.pdap	built-in pragmas
co.net	tcp, udp, http
co.const	true, false, none
co.encoding	base64Encode, base64Decode, json, yaml, bson
co.utils	makeImmutable, makeShared, copyOnWrite, toLiteral — object behaviour policies
co.dynamic	dynamic capabilities
co.runtime	
co.compiletime	
co.macro	
co.pattern	
co.control	
co.cPCA	concurrent, async, await, defer, lazy, parallel, process, thread, fiber, task, coroutine, continuation, cps, pool, channel ...
co.hokrtl	
co.hokrt	

Reserved Words with Properties/ methods

Reserved Words	properties	methods
this	"prototype", "base", "super", "proto", "object", "class", "module", "kind", "type", "struct", "instance", "callee", "args", "caller", "continue", "break", "fallthrough", "yield", "parent", "return"	
self (contextual keyword)	parent	
co	"dynamic", "macro", "hokrt", "hokrtl", "encoding", "net", "crypto", "nop", "lang", "dap", "ddap", "out", "const", "native", "meta", "core", "sys", "os", "in", "pattern", "control", "runtime", "comptime"	
forall		
for		
let	where	
fo (reserved word)		



# Built In Methods

method	Responsibilit
to_str	
to_int	
to_float	
to_double	
classof	
typeof	
new	
prototype	
proto	
make	
objectof	
instanceof	
is	
as	
iskindof	
has	
hasown	
uses	
match	
matchall	
matchany	
matchnone	
matchtype	
case	
with	
print	
println	
printsp	
echo	
contains	
cast	
to	
dummy	
clone	

method	Responsibilit
of	
for	
when	
where	
then	
callback	
getAttr	
inject	
isinstance	
cast_to	
cast_from	
do	
map	
flatMap	
orElse	
filter	
fold	
recover	
peek	
loop	
istrue	
isfalse	
if	
elif	
else	
return	
otherwise	
each	
containsVal	
in	
iterate	
foreach	
decltype	deduce the type at compile time
replace	
send	

method	Responsibilit
receive	
submitToPool	
submitToEventLoop	